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Wellington & District

LEADER

Covering news and views from within the Wellington, Eucharéena, Geurie, Goolma, Gollan, Mumbil, Stuart Town, Wongarbone and Yeoval districts.

Established August, 2021

Inc GST

No. 213

THURSDAY, December 11, 2025

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Home for Christmas?

Then bring the family for a relaxing afternoon at

BOXING DAY RACES

Friday, 26 December

Class of 1995

reunion - P4

Maliyan mural

complete - P5

Millie Mills gains

music awards P5

PAPA builds more for elderly

IDEALLY LOCATED within walking distance from the towns main shopping area, residents who move into the six new single and double accommodation units between Arthur Street and Swift Street will not be severely inconvenienced.

These are the fifth complex of units built for the Provision of Aged Person's Accommodation Association (PAPA) in as many decades.

The modern units are being constructed by Wellington builders Matt Redfern Constructions.

The cost of the project is \$3.5 million raised entirely by PAPA.

The association's president, Russell Nott said PAPA had borrowed \$2.5 million to cover the project.

PAPA has also purchased the house between the 1984-built Arthur Street units and the Wellington Hotel, which makes sure the new and existing units would not be landlocked, even with an entrance from Swift Street near the railway station.

PAPA was established in the 1970s to make sure aged accommodation was available to older people who were agile and able to live comfortably alone or as couples at a time when accommodation was limited for aging locals. The association also has units in Maxwell Street and Thornton Street.

This new project has been in the making for some time, but soon to come to fruition for people on the PAPA waiting list.



Provision for Aged Person's Accommodation (PAPA) president, Russell Nott with long-time committee member and association stalwart Dema Gersbach at the new six-unit complex being constructed between Arthur and Swift Streets.

Week

5

Inside

2025 Magical Christmas Feature

Support Locals in Wellington & Geurie

* Ben's Tyres

* Caves Wood Gallery & Gifts

* Cusack's Butchery

* Four Cats Coffee

* Jacinta Haycock Gallery

* Jespresso Cafe

* Mallee Hen's Nest & Cafe

* N J Jewellers

* Notts Rural and Domestic

* One Stop Auto

* Styled By Sim

* T & N Auto and Ag Services

* The Lemon Tree Cafe

* Wellington Craft Co-op

Wellington solar farm fire

It was disturbing to see the grass fire burn through the Wellington North Solar farm last Saturday.

It's a good thing there was no big lithium battery that caught fire as well.

The cause of the fire is under investigation and until the results of that are made public, I won't be speculating on the source of ignition.

However, there have apparently been a couple of previous fires at solar farms in our region.

Given the previous history of fires, I will be writing to the NSW Ministers' for Energy, Planning and Emergency Services asking for a review into the causes of various solar farm fires in our LGA and what more can be done to keep the community safe.

I won't be seeking these answers from a 'anti-renewables' position, simply from a viewpoint that these facilities are already existing in our community, with a large number proposed, and the community obviously deserves answers on the fire management plans and the safety of the facilities.

Community Funding Program NOW OPEN

Council is calling for submissions for the second assessment period of the Community Funding Program.

This is the proper channel to use when seeking to obtain grant funding from Council. APPLY EARLY – don't wait until two weeks before your event or activity. The Community Funding Program allows organisations to apply for financial assistance for events, projects, programs or activities that deliver community benefit outcomes for residents in the Dubbo Regional Local Government Area. In the first assessment period, Council awarded 18 community organisations with financial assistance to the amount of \$117,219.47 to support a variety of programs and events.

Some of the successful applicants include programs for low-cost desexing for companion animals, volunteer support to improve the health of the river, and an all-inclusive dementia Sing Out Choir pilot program. Several events also received financial assistance, including the NSW Jun-

ior Rugby State Championships, the Ranch Sorting National Championships and the Man from Ironbark Festival.

The Community Funding Program is an opportunity to apply for financial assistance to secure resources, deliver services and coordinate programs for the betterment of our community. Community groups and organisations that have projects or programs commencing after 1 May 2026 should apply. Applications must be submitted via SmartyGrants by 5pm 28 February 2026, to be considered for the assessment. For more information about the Community Funding Program visit: www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/funding.

Library extended loan period

Borrow a book before the Macquarie Regional Library branches close for Christmas break and a six-week loan period will apply to all physical book borrowed. This means you won't have to worry about returning until after the Christmas/New Year period. The usage figures at the library have been very high over the last little while and it is good to see this

vital community resource being used.

Disability Inclusion Action Plan (DIAP) Reference Group

Council has established a Disability Inclusion Action Plan (DIAP) Reference Group.

The group unites community members with a disability (or lived experience of disability) with representatives from government and non-government organisations.

Members have contributed valuable insights into issues affecting people with disability across the region, with these insights assisting in the creation of the DIAP.

Keep an eye out for the plan, which will go on public consultation in the future.

Contacting Council

Please remember that the first point of contact for all Council matters should be the front desk, phone 6801 4000, or use the DRC&ME web portal to report matters.

Commenting on Facebook posts is often easy, but doesn't actually result in Council being notified of problems.

Josh Black

Rural and regional delivering of domestic and family violence services way behind cities

A NEW report from Domestic Violence NSW (DVNSW) finds the costs of delivering domestic and family violence services in regional, rural, and remote communities is up to 8.94 times higher than cities. Without additional funding to meet these higher costs, victim-survivors outside major cities are being exposed to unacceptable levels of risk.

DVNSW, the peak body for approximately 200 specialist domestic and family violence services, is calling on the State Government to increase core funding for all services by 50 per cent, complemented by a supplementary payment for regional, rural and remote providers.

This would begin to address the heightened cost pressures and rising demand in these communities.

Increased funding is one of 12 recommendations in DVNSW's new report – Ending Violence in Regional and Remote NSW – which identifies key

drivers of high service delivery costs outside metropolitan areas, including:

- * Significantly higher rates of DFV (up to 7.45 times higher than major cities)
- * Geographical isolation and extensive travel requirements
- * Workforce shortages, recruitment and retention challenges, and increased role complexity
- * Limited infrastructure, crisis accommodation and safe housing options

Delia Donovan, CEO of DVNSW said the findings showed that victim-survivors in country NSW and the services supporting them, are being left behind in the state's response to DFV.

"Without immediate action, the combination of higher service delivery costs, limited crisis accommodation and workforce shortages will continue to expose women and children to harm," she said. "Specialist domestic and family violence services are also forced to operate beyond safe limits to try and

meet demand – this means potential burnout and victim-survivors being turned away."

The report draws on months of sector consultation, including a statewide Regional Forum in Armidale attended by more than 70 frontline workers, and service visits in Dubbo, Walgett, Nyngan, Lightning Ridge, Brewarrina, Coonamble, Lithgow, Taree and Port Macquarie during the 16 Days of Activism.

It shares lived examples from frontline workers going beyond their job descriptions to keep women and children safe – providing tents when no housing was available, paying for emergency vouchers out of their own pockets, and supporting waitlisted clients with ongoing safety planning. DVNSW says the report's 12 recommendations offer a targeted pathway to address challenges rooted in longstanding structural inequality.

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Wellington & District LEADER

In Memory of Beryl O'Brien

Covering news and views particularly from within the Wellington region, which now runs from Euchareena to Elong Elong within Dubbo Regional Council Local Government Area.

Wellington & District Leader is independently published locally by Mark Griggs and Sharon Wilson trading as Wellington District Leader, 14 Nancarrow Lane, Wellington, NSW, 2820, ABN: 26847723165 and printed by Gilgandra Newspapers, another independent and both members of CPNSW.

Editor: Mark Griggs
0456 940 999

email: mark@wdleader.news

Advertising Manager
Sharon Wilson
0407 935 998
email: sharon@wdleader.news

Community input and feedback is welcomed. Story leads, prepared articles and photographs can be forwarded to the publisher.

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Funeral Notice

Marion Sarah Dawson

Aged 85 years
Late of Wellington

Much loved wife to Leo (dec)
Adored mother of Tim, Garth and Paul.
Cherished grandmother and great grandmother.

Relatives and friends are warmly invited to attend Marion's funeral service to be held at
St Patrick's Catholic Church, Wellington, on Wednesday 17th December 2025, commencing at 10am. Followed by interment at the Wellington Lawn Cemetery.

H Logue & Sons Funerals, Wellington NSW
0268451946

Obituaries of our loved ones are welcomed for publication in the

"Leader"

Contact:

mark@wdleader.news

Community funding program now open

COUNCIL (DRC) is calling for submissions for the second assessment period of the Community Funding Program.

This funding program allows organisations to apply for financial assistance for events, projects, programs or activities that deliver community benefit outcomes for residents in the Local Government Area.

“In the first assessment period, Council awarded 18 community

organisations with financial assistance to the amount of \$117,219.47 to support a variety of programs and events,” Mayor, Josh Black said.

Some of the successful applicants included programs for low-cost desexing for companion animals, volunteer support to improve the health of the river, and an all-inclusive dementia Sing Out Choir pilot program.

Several events also received financial

assistance, including the NSW Junior Rugby State Championships, the Ranch Sorting National Championships and the Man from Ironbark Festival.

“The Community Funding Program is an opportunity to apply for financial assistance to secure resources, deliver services and coordinate programs for the betterment of our community,” Cllr Black said.

Community groups and organisations that

have projects or programs commencing after 1 May 2026 should apply.

“I encourage community groups and organisations to look at any upcoming projects and programs they may wish to seek financial assistance for.

“These projects should aim to help create, enhance or build community well-being and amenity.”

Applications must be submitted via Smarty-Grants by 5pm 28

February 2026, to be considered for the assessment.

For more information about the Community Funding Program visit www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/funding



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BreastScreen NSW expands machine reading to all women

FOLLOWING THE successful rollout of machine reading technology 12 months ago, BreastScreen NSW is expanding use to include mammography images of all first-time screeners.

The technology - initially used to read selected images from women aged 50-59 - has significantly reduced call backs for further tests, reducing stress for women, without compromising cancer detection rates.

By the end of 2025, it's predicted that as a direct result of the technology's accuracy, around 500, or 20 per cent fewer women, will be asked to return for additional tests, which can include a breast ultrasound and a needle biopsy.

Since the technology was intro-

duced, it's read more than 19,000 images and detected more than 130 cancers.

BreastScreen NSW was Australia's first population-based screening program to introduce the cutting-edge technology to support radiologists in interpreting a select range of mammography images.

Successfully used in similar international population-based screening programs, BreastScreen NSW undertook a world-first study to extensively evaluate the accuracy and efficacy of this new technology prior to its implementation.

The study showed the technology produced comparable results to the existing screening program, without compromising

cancer detection rates.

For women aged 50-74, a breast screen every two years is the best way to detect breast cancer early - before it can be seen or felt. Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander women are recommended to screen from age 40.

Early detection not only significantly increases a person's chance of survival, it can also greatly reduce the need for invasive treatment like a mastectomy.

Any woman who has noticed a change in their breasts, like a lump, should see their doctor without delay.

More information or make an appointment at a local BreastScreen NSW clinic or mobile van, call 13 20 50 or book online at www.breastscreen.nsw.gov.au

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Dubbo Regional Council Closures and Holiday Opening Hours

Dubbo Regional Council - Dubbo and Wellington Customer Experience Centres

CLOSED: 5pm, 19 Dec 2025 until 9am, 5 Jan 2026.

DRC&ME

Please note that any service requests lodged during this closure period will be actioned upon return.

For assistance with Council related emergencies contact:
02 6801 4000

Visitor Information Centres - Dubbo and Wellington

CLOSED: 4:30pm, 24 Dec 2025 until 8am, 27 Dec 2025.

Dubbo Regional Theatre and Convention Centre

CLOSED: 22 Dec 2025 until 5 January 2026.
Enquiries for funerals and wakes can be directed to Dubbo RSL on 02 6882 4411.

Wellington Civic Centre

CLOSED: 20 Dec 2025 until 5 Jan 2026.
Enquiries for funerals and wakes can be directed to Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club on 02 6845 2877.

Western Plains Cultural Centre and Creole Cafe

CLOSED: 24 Dec, 25 Dec, 26 Dec 2025 and 1 Jan 2026.

Macquarie Regional Library - Dubbo and Wellington

CLOSED: 12pm, 24 Dec 2025 until 10am, 5 Jan 2026. The online library can be accessed 24/7 during this time.

Old Dubbo Gaol

CLOSED: 25 Dec 2025 only.

Wellington Caves and Caravan Complex

CLOSED: 25 Dec 2025 only.

Dubbo Regional Botanic Gardens

CLOSED: 24 Dec, 25 Dec 2025 and 1 Jan 2026.

Rainbow Cottage

CLOSED: 20 Dec until 5 Jan 2026. Children return 6 Jan 2026.

Family Day Care

CLOSED: 20 Dec 2025 until 5 Jan 2026.

Dubbo Regional Animal Shelter

CLOSED: 25 Dec, 26 Dec 2025 and 1 Jan 2026.

Open for appointments for pick-ups and drop offs on non-closure days between 12pm - 3pm between 20 Dec 2025 and 5 Jan 2026. To make an appointment please call 6801 4640 and select option 3.

Rangers will continue to operate on skeleton staff during the closure period.

Dubbo Regional Livestock Markets

CLOSED: 4pm, 19 Dec 2025 until 5am, 5 Jan 2026. On call person for animal welfare. Truck wash available to Avdata key holders.

Dubbo Aquatic Leisure Centre, Wellington Aquatic Leisure Centre and Geurie Pool

CLOSED: 2pm, 24 Dec until 26 Dec 2025. Public Holiday hours may apply.

Waste Disposal Facilities

WHYLANDRA WASTE AND RECYCLING CENTRE CLOSED: 25 Dec 2025.
WELLINGTON WASTE FACILITY CLOSED: 25 Dec 2025.
TOONGI TRANSFER STATION CLOSED: 25 Dec 2025.
EUMUNGERIE TRANSFER STATION CLOSED: 25 Dec 2025.

Domestic Waste Collection

As per normal collection days.



Class of 1995 catch up back in their home town

THE CLASS of 1995 from Wellington High School held their latest reunion in Wellington on November 1, 10 years since their last catch-up, so it was great for them to reconnect.

Starting the evening at Black Cats for cocktails, the group then moved on to the Cow and Calf for dinner in the function area out the back where they could play some of the music from school days, which was said to really add to the atmosphere.

A number of their year's former teachers also joined for the night.

According to Caz Willis, who supplied the **"Leader"** with these photos, everyone had a fantastic time

"And it was especially special to see people some of us hadn't seen since we left school," she said.

"It's a reminder of how a group of people, brought together simply by age and the school our parents chose in our town, can form such long-lasting connections. We all feel we got pretty lucky."



Brad McCudden (WHS teacher), Vicki McCudden (Schnieder) WHS teacher, Ash McCarney, Michelle Wilson.



Ash McCarney and Carolyn Willis.



Alexia McDonald and Vicki McCudden.



Alexia McDonald, Michelle Wilson, Kate Rathbone, Vicki McCudden (Schnieder), Donna Howarth (Lee) WHS Teacher, Sam Bowie (Owens).



Paul Taylor, Sam Bowie (Owens), Kate Rathbone, Amanda Taylor.



Catherine Fuller, (Cussen), Melissa Cox (Stanley), Jo Clark (Bourke), Mel Rich, Michelle Wilson, Janis Milgate (Williamson).



Sam Bowie (Owens) and Alexia McDonald.



Greg Hoffman, Michelle Wilson, Sam Bowie (Owens), Donna Howarth (Lee).



Maliyan – Wedge tail eagle mural project gets wings

AFTER A weekend of enthusiastic painting, Wellington Arts members and others have successfully completed the third of a series of community contributed murals within the Orana region.

The first in Dubbo was the Bin Chicken mural, followed by the Kingfisher in Narromine.

This latest project in Wellington was again facilitated by Wongarbron artist Jack Randell of ArtClub and funded by Create NSW with support from Wellington Arts and other organisations.

Mr Randell said the project began with community consultation.

“We met people face-to-face while conducting design workshops and from these we drew out ideas of what people think would be good ideas for a mural that tells something about their community,” he said.

There were three suggestions including a water rat and a platypus.

“However, they were replaced by the Maliyan - Wedge tail eagle.”

With that brief Jack then designed the mural on the Maughan Street wall of Kitch & Sons building on the corner with Percy Street.

After endorsement, Jack set to and with help, washed-down the wall then drew the design and painted the eagle’s outline.



LEFT: The Maliyan - Wedge tail eagle mural on the Wall at Kitch & Sons, with Chris Tomlinson, Kerry Palmer, Jack Randell and Jan Payne.

There were more than a dozen helpers when the ‘Leader’ visited the site on Saturday.

He and helpers started the process last Wednesday and it was completed by Sunday.

“I hope this is a legacy that will go on for a number of years into the future,” he said.

“These colours are of high-quality pigments and will last for 20 years.”

Jack started his artistic painting career 40 years ago as a 14-year-old.



LEFT: Millie Mills won both peer, and panel voted Original Single Award, and People’s Choice Single of the Year Award for her Single released on Binjang Commuty Radio earlier this year - “I Won’t Think of You”, in the recent Dubbo Original Music Awards.

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Narelle Dorin drew the fourth lucky winner at her N J Jewellers shop in Nanima Crescent last Friday afternoon. And the lucky winner was Jacob Lee who chose to spend his \$100 prize at One Stop Auto.

One more draw to go

THE EXCITEMENT is gathering as we get close to the fifth and final \$100 cash draw in the 2025 **Wellington & District Leader** Magical Christmas local shopping spree.

Our next draw will be at The Lemon Tree Cafe at Geurie around 11am this Saturday with owners Tina and Adrea and staff.

This year there has been 15 Wellington and Geurie businesses and shops participating in the Christmas local shopping promotion encouraging locals to shop local and support their town businesses.

Our first draw was held at Jespresso where Sam Harries drew the winning ticket of Michelle O’Brien who chose to spend her winnings at Cusack’s Butchery.

Week 2 winner was Robyn Walker

who chose Mallee Hen’s Nest after her coupon was drawn out of the barrel by Ben Blackhall of Ben’s Tyres on the corner of Gobolion and Lee Streets.

Simone McManus of Styled by Sim in Swift Street drew our third winner, Caitlyn Kerin who is spending her winnings at Jespresso Cafe.

And Narelle Dorin at N J Jewellers in Nanima Crescent performed the fourth draw and pulled out the winning coupon of Jacob Lee, who chose to spend his \$100 at One Stop Auto.

Keep filling-in those coupons at our participating businesses advertising in our centre-fold liftout starting on page 11 and keep your ear to your phone on Saturday because you could be the next and final winner of the \$100 spending spree,



Sherry Amatto with Helen Norris and Emily Falson during the CWA presentation.

Wellington CWA donation supports empowering Women and students in the community

WELLINGTON BRANCH of the Country Women’s Association (CWA) is proud to share the generous support received from the CWA NSW Sydney City Branch, who donated \$1000 to the small but dedicated branch of 12 members.

This year, branch members focused on identifying a local cause that would make a meaningful difference in the lives of young people in our community and were introduced to the inspiring work of Jeff Amato, who leads the Darrambal Program—a school-based initiative designed to connect students with their Aboriginal culture while boosting school attendance, engagement, and wellbeing.

The program supports both male and female students by aligning cultural learning with school outcomes.

Students are monitored not only

throughout the program but into the following school year, with strong communication maintained with parents and guardians to reinforce learning at home.

The Wellington branch also learned about an inspiring young leader in our community, Sherry Amato, Jeff’s niece, who has been nominated as Wellington High School Captain for 2026.

Sherry attended our recent CWA meeting, held in Cameron Park during the unveiling of our 100-year centenary bench, honouring the remarkable women of the Wellington CWA.

This branch, established in 1922, is one of the oldest in NSW, and members take immense pride in the legacy passed along.

Sherry spoke to members about an upcoming Empowering Women Weekend, planned for February

2026 at Lake Burrendong.

Hosted by More Cultural Rehabs Less Jails, the three-day, two-night event will bring together 20 young Aboriginal women for healing, empowerment, and cultural connection.

The program will offer culturally safe activities, role-model engagement, water-based recreation, creative expression, self-care practices, and the distribution of dignity bags.

The weekend aims to nurture identity, resilience, and wellbeing—creating lasting memories and strong pathways for young women in Wellington.

Moved by Sherry’s passion and leadership, the Wellington CWA Branch unanimously decided to donate the \$1000 received from CWA Sydney City to support this important event for young women in this community.

Mid Macquarie Landcare update

Eco-Friendly Christmas tips

AS WE head into the festive season, there are plenty of simple ways to celebrate sustainably.

Choose reusable wrapping (fabric, newspaper, or last year’s gift bags), opt for locally made gifts, avoid single-use decorations, and consider experiences instead of items.

Tea Towels sales supporting our local projects

Our popular Micro Bats of Wellington and Dubbo Tea Towels have been updated with a new species and back in stock.

Featuring beautiful illustrations of all 16 species we’ve recorded in our Bats in Backyards project during 2024/25 and all proceeds go toward environmental projects in our region.

Order yours before the Christmas rush from Jess by reply email or phone 0457 115 525.

Mistletoe Mythbusters

We ran a couple of Mistletoe workshops with Birdlife Australia and Local Land Services in November.

Unless it’s the Christmas season, Mistletoe often gets a bad reputation, so since it’s the season for Mistletoe love, we’re busting a few myths about these gnarly parasites.

Did you know: Mistletoe is actually a keystone species, acting as an indicator of how healthy our local ecosystems are.

Its flowers and fruits are critical seasonal food sources for specialist feeders like Regent Honeyeaters and the Painted Honeyeater.

Myth: “Mistletoe kills trees.”

Fact: Healthy trees can host mistletoe without harm, and the plant supports birds, insects, and biodiversity.

Myth: “It’s a weed.”

Fact: Mistletoe is a Native, keystone species providing a wide range of fauna species with abundant fruit and nectar, nutritious leaves, secure nesting sites and a steady stream of enriched litter.

Stay tuned for our upcoming social media series debunking more mistletoe myths.

Nature Spotters – Next Term

Nature Spotters will return next term for our citizen scientists between 8 - 14 years.

Program details and dates will be shared early in the new year.

Keep an eye on our website for more information about Nature Spotters including fun pics from this year’s program

Indian Myna Traps

Mid Macquarie Landcare is helping to combat the Indian Myna Bird invasion in the Wellington region.

If you have seen Indian Mynas on your street/property, you can either purchase a small portable pee gee trap from Landcare for \$60, or if you are a member in the Wellington area, you can apply to host the group’s aviary trailer trap to carry out trapping on your property.

Merry Christmas from our team

A big thank-you to all our members, volunteers, partners, landholders, schools, and community supporters.

Your contributions make a real difference to the health of our landscapes.

We wish you a safe, happy, and environmentally friendly Christmas, and we look forward to working with you again in the new year.

Happenings at Yeoval Central School

AS WE approach the eve of our most eagerly anticipated event of the year, our students have been dedicating themselves tirelessly to making the 2025 YCS Presentation Night a truly memorable occasion.

In preparation, students have been rehearsing presentations and collaborating with staff to create an engaging program that reflects the spirit and values of our school community.

Celebrating the outstanding accomplishments and growth of our students, this special event is a highlight of the school calendar and a wonderful way to end the school year.

Little Eagles graduation

As Term 4 draws to a close, a special

celebration took place to honour the graduation of our Little Eagles.

George, Harrison, Hunter, Kieser, Oakley and Wyatt were each presented with certificates and a YCS backpack as they prepare to begin their kindergarten journey in 2026.

We value your feedback

We extend our gratitude to all parents who took part in the recent survey conducted by Mrs Kate Weber.

Your feedback is greatly appreciated and we warmly encourage all parents and carers to reach out to us directly with any concerns or suggestions at any time during the year.

Trish Henderson, Principal

Lunch

WELLINGTON BUDDHIST CENTRE hosted a Benefactor’s Lunch last Saturday with prayers led by Ven. Loppon Norbu Bhutia.

The ceremony was followed by one of the best vegetarian meals in town, courtesy of our local Buddhist team.



Andrew GEE MP

INDEPENDENT FEDERAL MEMBER FOR CALARE

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Independent



RUNS ON THE BOARD FOR WELLINGTON

- ✓ \$9.5 million for Maranatha House Aged Care
- ✓ Introduced Bill into Parliament to ban foreign buying of residential property for two years. The Coalition and the Labor Party voted against it and then they both announced it as their policy!
- ✓ Backed Independents' Bill to reduce dominance of big supermarkets. All major parties voted against it and then Coalition announced it as their policy!
- ✓ \$50 million for storm and flood recovery in the Central West
- ✓ Secured the Parliamentary Inquiry into the Disaster
- ✓ Response of Insurers \$2 billion for Great Western Highway upgrade
- ✓ \$2.02 million for replacing the Terrabella, Burrendong and Gundy Creek Bridges
- ✓ \$738,000 for the Cameron Park footbridge
- ✓ 60 mobile phone towers and base stations for Calare
- ✓ \$560,000 for Stuart Town water security project
- ✓ Secured upgrade of Wellington Hospital Emergency Department
- ✓ \$1.5 million for the intergenerational childcare facility at
- ✓ Wellington's Maranatha House
- ✓ \$1.1 million for Ponto Falls Road upgrade
- ✓ \$26,700 for the Driver Reviver site at the Wellington Information Centre
- ✓ \$1.176 million for improvements at Wellington Caves
- ✓ \$1.2 million for security CCTV in Wellington and Calare communities
- ✓ \$650,000 for upgrades at Wellington Christian School
- ✓ \$200,000 for improvements at Kennard Park
- ✓ \$46,454 for Geurie Racecourse and Recreation Reserve Revitalisation Project Stage Two
- ✓ \$50,000 for Wellington Library's outdoor reading room
- ✓ Video link for Wellington Court House

CALL FOR FEDERAL PROBE INTO MEROTHERIE ROAD DESTRUCTION

I've written to Federal Environment Minister Murray Watt requesting he launch a federal inquiry into the environmental vandalism underway near Gulgong.

The NSW Government, through EnergyCo and ACERZ, recently bulldozed and woodchipped almost 700 centuries-old native trees along Merotherie Road to make way for the Central West Orana Renewable Energy Zone.

Despite considerable pushback from the

Mid-Western Regional Council, who refused to approve the works, the state government flattened this critical native wildlife corridor during bird nesting season.

This high conservation corridor was home to many breeds that had just hatched baby chicks. After the trees were felled, more than 60 orphaned and injured fledgling birds were rescued by wildlife carers, community members and even EnergyCo consultants, and handed to local vets and WIRES volunteers.

The NSW Government are dodging responsibility

for this appalling destruction, which has spurred local and universal outrage.

Everyone is asking the same question, how could this moonscape have been allowed to happen?

The Rylstone District Environment Society, supported by Council, has called for the investigation into the legality of this environmental disaster, setting out alleged breaches of federal law.

I'm backing in their call because the NSW Government cannot be allowed to be a law unto themselves.

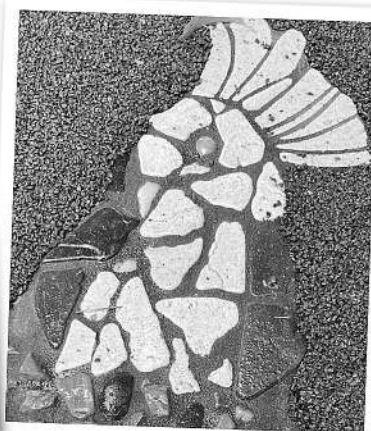


Total destruction! Andrew with local farmer Pilly Armstrong



THANK YOU, BRIAN! OPENING OF RECONCILIATION WALKWAY – CATHERINE MCAULEY SCHOOL, ORANGE

Wellington Wiradjuri man Brian Ah-See performed a smoking ceremony at the opening of the reconciliation walkway at Catherine McAuley School in Orange last week. Thank you, Brian.



FEDERAL INTERVENTION NEEDED TO PROTECT PRIME AGRICULTURAL LAND AND RURAL COMMUNITIES

The Merotherie environmental disaster is a glaring example of the NSW Government's disrespect for our regional communities and rural landscape.

It underscores and validates my call for the urgent introduction of federal protection of our prime agricultural land.

My Protecting Prime Agricultural Land Bill 2025 will make it 'off limits' to housing sprawl, parking lots, industrial and renewable projects, and mining. My Bill requires that prime agricultural land must be used for agriculture.

However, when I put it to a vote in Parliament recently, only one National Party MP and one Liberal MP supported it.

What the NSW Government has done at Merotherie Road is a shambles and highlights the flaws we have in our NSW planning and environmental laws.

We need to act now to protect our communities and our agricultural land. Our future national food security is at stake.

I will be continuing to press forward my Bill in Parliament next year.



ORANGE ELECTORATE OFFICE

📍 1/179a Anson Street

✉ PO Box 673

Orange NSW 2800

☎ (02) 6361 7138

@ andrew.gee.mp@aph.gov.au

🌐 www.andrewgeemp.com.au

For regular updates and news,
follow me on Facebook and
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Authorised by Andrew Gee MP, Suite 1/179a Anson Street Orange NSW 2800

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Public Notice

An Open Invitation
to attend the ‘Farewell’
to Father Carl McKander
on his retirement - 7pm
Saturday, 3 January
Infant De Prague Hall
Wellington.
RSVP for catering purposes
026845 2061

Church Services

Anglican Parish of Wellington
WELLINGTON – St John the Baptist Church
Sunday 9am
Sunday 5pm - The Gathering
MARANATHA
11am on 2nd & 4th Friday of month.

Wellington Baptist Church
77 Swift Street
9:30am Sunday mornings
6pm Evening Service

Wellington Uniting Church
Sunday at 9.30am

St Patrick’s Catholic Parish

Saturday
6pm – Mass, St Patrick’s Church, Wellington
8.30am - Stuart Town

Sunday
8am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
10am – Our Lady’s Church, Yeoval second and fourth Sundays of the month
10am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington first, third and fifth Sundays of the month
8am – St Patrick’s Church, Wellington second and fourth Sundays of the month
Weekday mass
Please check parish bulletin

In Christ Chapel
2pm Sunday

Riverside Church Inc.
170 Thornton Street
Sunday: 10.00am Service
Thursday: Bible Study for Men and Women 10.30 am

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Around the electorate

with our State Member **Dugald Saunders**

Disaster declared
A NATURAL Disaster Declaration has been made for the Dubbo Regional Council local government area, following a series of bushfires across NSW over the weekend. This declaration activates a suite of financial support measures to Council and for residents, businesses and primary producers. Impacted community members should contact Service NSW on 13 77 88 or visit <https://www.service.nsw.gov.au/services/emergencies-and-natural-disasters> to access information on disaster assistance, grants, and recovery support. The RFS Orana team will also be hosting community meetings for those affected by the Garlings Road and Dunedoo Road/Beni Fires this Sunday, 14 December, at the Elong Elong Fire Station from 1pm to 2pm and at the Boothernba Fire Station from 4pm to 5.30pm. These meetings are an opportunity for those impacted to ask questions, discuss concerns, and gain a clearer understanding of the incident and response.

E-Bike Licencing
The NSW Nationals and Liberal Coalition has announced a commitment to introducing an Australian first, low-cost licence plate scheme for certain categories of e-bike riders, putting community safety, responsible riding and practical enforcement at the centre of future active-transport regulation. This initiative will enable clearer and more consistent safety expectations, support better rider accountability, and give local councils, police and the community practical tools to promote safe behaviour. Under the proposed scheme, a government-issued identification plate would be required for:
* Riders under the age of 18;
* Riders who use e-bikes for a commercial purpose; and,
* Commercial shared service schemes. Riders aged 18 and over, using a privately-owned e-bike, would be exempt from the requirement. The commitment follows extensive consultation with stakeholders, including

police, local councils, community groups and safety experts, alongside last year’s NSW Parliamentary inquiry into e-bike safety. It also includes expanded safety education for young riders, ensuring they understand the risks associated with e-bike technology and how to use these devices responsibly in the community. New penalties for non-compliance will support consistent standards and rider accountability. The NSW Nationals and Liberal Coalition will implement this licence-plate scheme once elected to Government after the March 2027 State Election.

Closure Orders Issued
Five premises within the Dubbo area have been issued with closure orders under new powers allowing NSW Health to breach businesses selling illicit tobacco, or illegal vaping goods, or selling tobacco or non-tobacco smoking products without a

valid licence. Once a closure order is issued, it is an offence to sell any products from the premises for the period of the closure order, and no-one is able to enter the premises, except those people with an exemption or with a reasonable excuse. There are significant penalties for continuing to sell product from a premises subject to a closure order or for entering the closed premises without reasonable cause or an exemption. If you believe a business is continuing to operate whilst subject to a closure order, you can make a report by calling the Tobacco Information Line on 1800 357 412 or online through NSW Health’s online reporting portal. For more, visit: <https://www.health.nsw.gov.au/tobacco/Pages/closure-orders.aspx>

Until next time,
Dugald

Preservation society for Stuart Town and district

GRAND OPENING of the Stuart Town Preservation and History Society will be held on Saturday, January 24, 2026 during the Australia Day weekend. The RTC rooms will now be headquarters/home to the society. Many locals have expressed interest in being part of the society. Its aim is to preserve the town history starting with the town archives which are planned to digitise. Also, an aim to be able to provide information on the history of the town and surrounds to locals and

visitors especially people looking to trace family. As well, looking at the preservation of old buildings like the School of Arts Hall, Boehmes hall and the Railway Hotel. This will be a long-term project, and anyone with an interest in the town and district's history or anyone who wants to share history or photos are invited. Times and opening hours will be posted on the Society's new website. This is an official site and project with a lot of support from the community.

Wellington dryland wheat competition finds top local crops

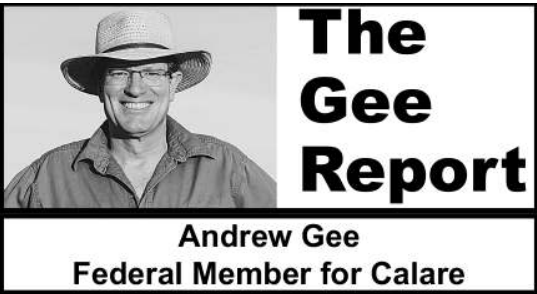
Winner: RG & MA Sutherland (Rob & Tom, Spicers Creek, Variety: Lancer, Apparent Yield: 6.8 t/ha. Second: Blacksky Partnership (Ken Blackburn & Fiona Adams), Bakers Swamp, Variety: Sunmaster, Apparent Yield: 6.0 t/ha. Third: Lechidale Partnership (Nick & Sue Knowles), Bodangora, Variety: Sunmaster, Apparent Yield: 5.0 t/ha. Fourth: Spicers Run (Sam & Joe Mason); Spicers Creek, Variety: Raider, Apparent Yield: 5.4 t/ha. Fifth: PR & PG O'Brien (Peter O'Brien), Arthurville, Variety: Condo, Apparent Yield: 4.4 t/ha. Sixth: New Oakleigh Ag (Sam, Joe & Matt Mason), Walmer, Variety: Kittyhawk, Apparent Yield: 4.4 t/ha.



AT ASSEMBLY recently Wellington Public School Debating Team were presented their participation awards from the Kerri Parkes for the Western Debate Challenge and the Premier's Debating Challenge. The Sky Blues Team were also presented their Zone Champion Awards in the Premier's Debating Challenge. They were undefeated in the initial rounds and the school thanked Mrs Hawke for all of her hard work preparing the team.

Federal intervention needed to protect prime agricultural land and rural communities

THE MEROTHERIE environmental atrocity is a glaring example of the NSW Government's complete disrespect for our regional communities and rural landscape. It underscores and validates my call for a Federal Government investigation into the issue, as well as the urgent introduction of federal protection of our prime agricultural land. The NSW Government has lost the trust of communities following the recent bulldozing of almost 700 centuries-old trees along the Merotherie Road wildlife corridor, which caused the death, injury and orphaning of fledgling native birds. Through their company EnergyCo, the state government literally created a moonscape to erect transmission lines for the Central-West Orana Renewable Energy Zone. This is something you might have expected to see back in the 50s, 60s and 70s, but not in modern Australia in 2025. They could easily have gone around the trees by putting in a new road on land it already owns just over the fence, which is bare paddock. Instead, they mowed the trees down to save money. People are shocked that the NSW Government gave the green light for this crime against the environment. Such vandalism, just to save a few bucks, does not pass the 'pub test'. In fact, the state government's social licence to operate is shot to pieces. It's rare that an issue galvanises a community the way that this one has – but the plight of the surviving baby birds and the 'scorched earth' tactics of EnergyCo are reprehensible. As the perpetrator of this environmental vandalism, and for dodging all responsibility, the NSW Government's arrogance is now squarely in the spotlight. They cannot be allowed to be a law unto themselves! The NSW Government has the power to do as



it pleases, declaring projects 'Critical State Significant Infrastructure'. The most distressing issue is that this power is being wielded with 100 per cent arrogance and zero responsibility for the consequences. There's a complete lack of regard for the impacts on local communities and the local environment. It's a shambles, and it highlights the flaws we have in our NSW planning and environmental laws when you have a state government being able to get away with this. We need to act now to protect our communities and our prime agricultural land. Our future national food security is at stake. I will be continuing to press forward my Protecting Australia's Prime Agricultural Land Bill 2025, which will make prime agricultural land 'off limits' to renewable projects, industrial and mining projects housing sprawl and parking lots. When I put it to a vote in Parliament recently only one National Party MP and one Liberal MP voted for it. But this fight is far from over. For generations the major political parties across all levels of government have been buck passing. And the NSW Government has just demonstrated this again with Merotherie. The Federal Government has the power to fix this, and we need it to take a leadership role and use that power.

Christmas Carols and Town Band Christmas Concert

GEURIE Lions Club will be conducting their annual Geurie Christmas Carols at the Geurie Racecourse building tomorrow evening (Friday) starting at 7pm. Dubbo Sing Australia and Geurie Public School students will be among performers on the night, and a special visit from Santa will top-off and incredible fun evening. Take a chair or rug for the family's comfort and work up the hunger pangs for the Lion's excellent sausage sizzle.

Town Band performance WELLINGTON TOWN Band will be performing their annual Christmas Carols concert at the Uniting church in Maxwell Street from 7pm this Sunday, December 14. It's the band's annual Christmas singalong and supper and every voice is invited to join in. Organisers are asking a \$5 donation towards a fundraiser to benefit the Christmas Bowl Appeal. The after-concert supper will please anybody who enjoys good food.

with

Mathew Dickerson, Axxis Comworld

EVERY YEAR around this time I promise myself I won't get carried away - and every year I fail spectacularly. What began as a humble 2G Gadget Guide for Christmas back in 2020 has snowballed into a full-fledged G-arms race. Readers loved 3G, so I made 4G. Then 5G. And by 6G I realised I'd accidentally locked myself into the same sort of relentless upgrade cycle that telcos use to sell phones. So here we are, in 2025, at the mighty 7G: the Glorious Grand Great Geek Gadget Gift Guide. No dropouts, no buffering - just some cracking ideas to help you gift like a geek. Let's start at the top with a breakfast revolution. Breville's latest toaster is less of a kitchen appliance and more of a bread-whisperer. It doesn't toast by time; it toasts by colour, as if it's judging your sourdough with the seriousness of a reality TV cooking judge. Jumping from heat to air, the world's smallest desk blower is the ultimate stocking-stuffer.

It blasts away crumbs and keyboard gunk and saves you from the annual post-Christmas clean-out where you discover enough biscuit debris to feed a small marsupial. It's tiny, bright orange and makes cleaning feel almost... fun. If you'd rather slice than sweep, the geeky glass chopping board is an instant conversation starter. It looks like you're prepping carrots on a motherboard - perfect for anyone who feels their kitchen could use a few more circuits. For the young concert fanatics, the clever crowd-connecting compass takes a different tack. Operating on mesh radio instead of mobile networks, it keeps groups together even in places where reception is as mythical as a unicorn. Think music festivals, hiking trips, or simply finding your friends on New Year's Eve. If your festive spirit wanes in traffic, an LED hand-gesture sign for your car may tempt you. It lights up whatever message your hand is trying to send - polite, cheeky or downright

cathartic. Used responsibly, it could introduce a little humour into peak-hour. Used irresponsibly... well, it might land you on Santa's naughty list. Keeping the futuristic theme rolling, the Hoverpen Interstellar gives you a levitating desk ornament that also happens to write. Suspended magnetically at Earth's tilt, it's equal parts tool, toy and science lesson. Flick it and it spins like a planetary model, proving once and for all that stationery is more fun when not stationary. For the thinkers on your list, a glowing smart chess board merges analogue tradition with tech smarts. You can play online opponents with your physical pieces. It's very Harry Potter without the risk of the knight actually galloping off the board. Households needing indoor sport will love the hover-football disc: air-hockey meets soccer. It glides across tiles, bumps gently off walls and tires out children faster than a Boxing Day sale queue.

Fans of tiny tech can slip a G-SHOCK Nano ring-watch onto their finger: shock-proof, waterproof and only one-tenth the size of the classic. It's the toughest piece of jewellery this side of a tradie's pinkie. Animal lovers get their own treat with a smart bird feeder that records, identifies and notifies you when feathered visitors drop in - a backyard aviary crossed with a nature documentary. Rounding out the list: a pocket Star Wars sound machine; a retro record-player kitchen timer helps geeks in the kitchen; kid-friendly night-vision goggles for backyard sleuthing; and finally, a companion robot that patrols your home like a friendly R2-D2 on wheels. And that's the 7G Guide done. Same time next year for 8G? I promise nothing... but history suggests otherwise. *** I am feeling generous this year! Send a question or comment about this article to ask@techtalk.digital and the first ten e-mails will receive a FREE Tech Talk compilation book! Get curious, get a freebie!



6.00 Morning Programs. **10.00** When The War Is Over. **10.25** The Piano UK. **11.30** Crime Night! Final. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** Silent Witness. **2.00** Death In Paradise. **3.00** QI. **3.30** Nigella Bites. **3.55** Grand Designs New Zealand. **4.40** Long Lost Family: What Happened Next. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** Grand Designs Australia. **9.00** Long Lost Family. **9.45** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **10.35** ABC Late News. **10.50** The Business. Final. **11.10** The Art Of. **11.40** Late Programs.



6.00 Sunrise. **9.00** The Morning Show. **12.00** **MOVIE:** A Christmas Spark. (2022) Jane Seymour. **2.00** Bridge Of Lies. **3.00** Beat The Chasers UK. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6:30. **7.00** **7NEWS Special: Roger Climpson. 7.30 7NEWS: 2025 Year In Review. 8.30** **MOVIE:** Robin Hood. (2010) Russell Crowe. **11.30** The Amazing Race. **1.00** Life. **2.00** Home Shopping. **4.00** NBC Today. **5.00** Sunrise Early News. **5.30** Sunrise.



6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra Summer. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** **MOVIE:** Sincerely Truly Christmas. (2023) **2.00** Pointless. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** Great Getaways. Return. **8.30** Topknotz: Wild On Water. **9.30** Limitless With Chris Hemsworth. **10.30** Chicago Med. **11.20** Next Stop. **11.50** Tipping Point. **12.40** Pointless. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **2.00** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **10.00** Ent. Tonight. **10.30** Jamie's 5 Ingredient Mediterranean. **11.30** My Market Kitchen. **12.00** Farm To Fork. **12.30** Family Feud. **1.00** News. **2.00** Deal Or No Deal. **2.30** Lingo. **3.30** News. **4.00** House Hunters Australia. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.00** 10 News+. **7.00** Deal Or No Deal. **7.30** The Graham Norton Show. **8.40** Neighbours. Final. **9.40** Law & Order: SVU. **10.40** 10's Late News. **11.05** Law & Order: SVU. **12.05** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** WorldWatch. **2.00** South America With Simon Reeve. **3.10** Going Places With Ernie Dingo. **3.40** The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. **4.10** Britain By Beach. **5.05** Jeopardy! **5.30** Letters And Numbers. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.35** Eva Longoria: Searching For Spain. **8.25** Niagara Falls. **9.25** Vigil. **10.30** SBS World News Late. **11.00** Vienna Blood. **12.50** House Of Promises. **3.30** Charles I: Downfall Of A King. **4.40** Bamay. **5.00** Late Programs.

7two **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.00** The Great Australian Doorstep. **2.30** Our Town. **3.00** The Zoo. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** Medical Emergency. **4.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.30** Escape To The Country. **6.30** Bargain Hunt. **7.30** Father Brown. **8.30** The Inspector Lynley Mysteries. **10.30** Late Programs.

7mate **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.30** The Force: Behind The Line. **3.30** Billy The Exterminator. **4.30** American Restoration. **5.00** Storage Wars. **5.30** American Pickers. **6.30** Pawn Stars. **7.00** Cricket. Women's Big Bash League. Finals. The Challenger. **10.30** Seven's Cricket: The Spin. **11.15** **MOVIE:** 65. (2023) **1.15** Late Programs.

7flix **6.00** Morning Programs. **9.00** Home Shopping. **10.00** The Food Dude. **10.30** My Kitchen Rules. **12.00** S.W.A.T. **3.00** 10 Years Younger In 10 Days. **4.00** Jabba's Movies School Holiday Special. **4.30** Bondi Vet. **6.30** Judge Judy. **7.30** Ramsay's Kitchen Nightmares. **10.30** Ramsay's 24 Hours To Hell And Back. **11.30** Late Programs.

10 drama **6.00** Home Shopping. **8.00** Escape Fishing With E.T. **9.00** The Living Room. **10.00** JAG. **12.00** Days Of Our Lives. **12.45** The Young And The Restless. **1.30** The Real CSI: Miami. **2.30** JAG. **4.30** The Living Room. **5.30** JAG. **7.30** NCIS. **10.20** Miniseries: Crossfire. **11.15** Blue Bloods. **12.15** 48 Hours. **2.15** Home Shopping.

10 comedy **6.00** Morning Programs. **11.00** Ghosts. **12.00** Ridiculousness. **2.00** The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. **3.00** Becker. **3.30** Frasier. **4.00** Farm To Fork. **4.30** Frasier. **5.00** Becker. **5.30** Frasier. **6.30** Friends. **8.00** The Big Bang Theory. **9.30** Becker. **10.00** Frasier. **10.30** South Park. **11.00** Ridiculousness. **11.30** Late Programs.

Entertains **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.05** ER. **2.50** Heartbreak High. **3.35** A Bite To Eat. **4.05** QI. **4.40** MythBusters. **5.30** Remarkable Renovations. **6.15** Phil Spencer: Secret Agent Specials. **7.05** Claire Hooper's House Of Games. **7.35** QI. **8.05** Would I Lie To You? **8.35** Hard Quiz. **9.05** Gruen. **9.45** Late Programs.

Family **6.00** Kids' Programs. **5.30** Peter Rabbit. **6.05** PJ Masks. **6.25** The Adventures Of Paddington. **6.45** Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. **7.05** Batwheels. **7.35** Ninjago: Dragons Rising. **8.00** Operation Ouch! **8.30** Secrets Of The Zoo. **9.10** Secret Life Of The Kangaroo. **10.00** The Wonderful World Of Puppies. **10.40** Late Programs.

NEWS **6.00** Morning Programs. **3.00** ABC News Afternoons. **4.00** ABC News Summer. Return. **5.00** ABC News With Joe O'Brien. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** 7.30. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.45** The Business. Final. **9.00** The World. **10.00** ABC Nightly News. **10.30** The Pacific. **11.00** Late Programs.

Gem **6.00** Morning Programs. **1.00** The Good Karma Hospital. **3.00** Antiques Roadshow. **3.30** **MOVIE:** School For Scoundrels. (1960) **5.30** Yorkshire Auction House. **6.30** Antiques Roadshow. **7.30** Clarkson's Farm. **8.30** **MOVIE:** On Her Majesty's Secret Service. (1969) George Lazenby, Diana Rigg. **11.30** Late Programs.

VICELAND **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.45** Insight. **3.45** WorldWatch. **5.45** Mysteries From Above. **6.40** Jeopardy! **7.35** 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. **8.30** History's Greatest Mysteries. **10.10** The UnXplained With William Shatner. **11.00** Homicide: Life On The Street. **12.45** Normal People. **2.25** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **1.00** The Newsreader. Final. **2.00** Grand Designs Australia. **3.00** QI. **3.30** Nigella Bites. **3.55** Grand Designs New Zealand. **4.40** Long Lost Family: What Happened Next. **5.30** Antiques Roadshow. **6.30** Hard Quiz. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** Australian Chamber Orchestra's 50th Gala. **8.30** Maigret. Final. **9.25** Hard Quiz. Final. **9.55** Crime Night! Final. **10.25** Spicks And Specks. **10.55** ABC Late News. Final. **11.15** Silent Witness. Final. **12.15** Late Programs.



6.00 Sunrise. **9.00** The Morning Show. **12.00** **MOVIE:** Cooking Up Christmas. (2020) **2.00** Bridge Of Lies: Celebrity Specials. **3.00** Beat The Chasers UK. **4.00** Seven News At 4. **5.00** The Chase Australia. **6.00** 7News Local. **6.30** 7News @ 6:30. **7.00** Better Homes And Gardens Summer. **8.30** **MOVIE:** The Holiday. (2006) **11.10** **MOVIE:** Morbius. (2022) Jared Leto, Matt Smith. **1.15** Miniseries: Any Human Heart. **2.30** Home Shopping. **4.00** Million Dollar Minute. **5.00** NBC Today.



6.00 Today. **9.00** Today Extra Summer. **11.30** 9News Morning. **12.00** **MOVIE:** Christmas At Carbell Family Farm. (2024) **2.00** Pointless. **3.00** Tipping Point. **4.00** 9News Afternoon. **4.30** Tipping Point Australia. **5.30** WIN News. **6.00** 9News. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** Swimming. Australia v The World. **10.30** Law & Order: Organized Crime. **11.30** Next Stop. **12.00** Tipping Point. **1.00** Drive TV: Launch Pad. **1.30** TV Shop: Home Shopping. **4.00** Skippy The Bush Kangaroo. **4.30** Global Shop. **5.00** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **8.00** Bold. **8.30** Deal Or No Deal. **9.00** Lingo. **10.00** Ent. Tonight. **10.30** Jamie's Cook Ahead Christmas. **11.30** My Market Kitchen. **12.00** Farm To Fork. **12.30** Family Feud. **1.00** News. **2.00** Deal Or No Deal. **2.30** Lingo. **3.30** 10 News: Afternoon. **4.00** House Hunters Australia. **4.30** The Bold And The Beautiful. **5.00** 10 News. **6.00** 10 News+. **7.00** Deal Or No Deal. **7.30** Love It Or List It Australia. **9.50** The Graham Norton Show. **11.00** 10's Late News. **11.25** 10 News+. **12.20** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** WorldWatch. **2.00** South America With Simon Reeve. **3.05** Going Places With Ernie Dingo. **3.35** The Cook Up With Adam Liaw. **4.05** Nazca Desert Mystery. **5.05** Jeopardy! **5.30** Letters And Numbers. **6.00** Mastermind Australia. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** Jaws: Making A Splash In Hollywood. **8.30** William Shatner: You Can Call Me Bill. **10.15** SBS World News Late. **10.45** Sisi. **11.40** Culpits. **1.50** Soldiers. **3.35** Late Programs.

7two **6.00** Morning Programs. **1.00** Escape To The Country. **2.00** The Zoo. **2.30** Our Town. **3.00** The Great Australian Doorstep. **3.30** Harry's Practice. **4.00** Medical Emergency. **4.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.30** Escape To The Country. **6.30** Bargain Hunt. **7.30** Wildlife ER. **8.30** Escape To The Country. **11.30** Late Programs.

7mate **6.00** Morning Programs. **3.30** Billy The Exterminator. **4.30** American Restoration. **5.00** Storage Wars. **5.30** American Pickers. **6.30** Pawn Stars. **7.30** Road Wars. **8.30** **MOVIE:** The Last Of The Mohicans. (1992) Daniel Day-Lewis, Madeleine Stowe. **10.55** **MOVIE:** Close Encounters Of The Third Kind. (1977) **1.55** Late Programs.

7flix **6.00** Morning Programs. **1.00** Around The World With Manu. **3.30** 10 Years Younger In 10 Days. **4.30** The Goldbergs. **5.30** Bondi Vet. **6.20** **MOVIE:** The Mitchells Vs The Machines. (2021) **8.30** **MOVIE:** Grown Ups. (2010) Adam Sandler, David Spade. **10.40** **MOVIE:** Happiest Season. (2020) **12.50** Late Programs.

10 drama **6.00** Home Shopping. **8.00** Escape Fishing With E.T. **9.00** The Living Room. **10.00** JAG. **12.00** Days Of Our Lives. **12.45** The Young And The Restless. **1.30** The Real CSI: Miami. **2.30** JAG. **4.30** All 4 Adventure. **5.30** JAG. **7.30** NCIS. **10.20** Miniseries: Crossfire. **11.15** Blue Bloods. **12.15** 48 Hours. **2.15** Home Shopping.

10 comedy **6.00** Morning Programs. **12.00** Ridiculousness. **2.00** The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. **3.00** Becker. **3.30** Frasier. **4.00** Farm To Fork. **4.30** Frasier. **5.00** Becker. **5.30** Frasier. **6.30** Neighbours. **7.30** **MOVIE:** Forrest Gump. (1994) Tom Hanks. **10.10** Becker. **10.35** South Park. **11.05** Frasier. **11.30** Late Programs.

Entertains **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.50** Heartbreak High. **3.35** A Bite To Eat. **4.05** Would I Lie To You? **4.35** MythBusters. **5.30** Remarkable Renovations. **6.15** Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. **7.05** House Of Games. **7.35** QI. **8.05** Would I Lie To You At Christmas? **8.35** **MOVIE:** Fracture. (2007) **10.25** Late Programs.

Family **6.00** Kids' Programs. **5.30** Peter Rabbit. **6.05** PJ Masks. **6.25** The Adventures Of Paddington. **6.45** Ben And Holly's Little Kingdom. **7.05** Gardening Australia Junior. **7.35** Star Wars: Young Jedi Adventures. **8.00** Scooby-Doo And Guess Who? **8.25** Hard Quiz Kids. Final. **8.55** Robot Wars. **9.55** Merlin. **10.35** Late Programs.

NEWS **6.00** Morning Programs. **3.00** News. **4.00** ABC News Summer. **5.00** ABC News With Joe O'Brien. Final. **6.00** ABC News Hour. **7.00** ABC National News. **7.30** ABC Evening News. **8.00** ABC News Tonight. **8.30** Heywire. **9.00** The World. **9.30** Close Of Business. Final. **10.00** ABC Nightly News. **10.30** Late Programs.

Gem **6.00** Morning Programs. **1.00** **MOVIE:** Nickelodeon. (1976) **3.30** Antiques Roadshow. **3.50** **MOVIE:** If I Only Had Christmas. (2020) **5.30** Yorkshire Auction House. **6.30** Antiques Roadshow. **7.30** Antiques Downunder. **8.30** **MOVIE:** Diamonds Are Forever. (1971) Sean Connery, Jill St John. **11.00** The Equalizer. **12.00** Late Programs.

VICELAND **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.10** History's Greatest Of All-Time With Peyton Manning. **3.00** Bamay. **3.40** WorldWatch. **5.40** If You Are The One. **6.40** Jeopardy! **7.35** 8 Out Of 10 Cats Does Countdown. **8.30** Virgin Island. **10.30** Adam Hills: The Last Leg. **11.20** Married To The Music. **12.50** Late Programs.



6.00 Rage Charts. **7.00** Weekend Breakfast. **9.00** Rage. **12.00** ABC News At Noon. **12.30** Return To Paradise. **1.25** Maigret. Final. **2.20** All Creatures Great And Small. **3.10** Le Concert De Paris 2025. **5.00** Spicks And Specks. **5.30** Muster Dogs: Where Are They Now. **6.00** Back Roads. **6.30** When The War Is Over. **7.00** ABC News. **7.30** Return To Paradise. **8.30** Vera. **10.00** The Forsytes. **10.55** Bergerac. **11.40** Rage.



6.00 NBC Today. **7.00** Weekend Sunrise. **10.00** The Morning Show: Weekend. **12.00** Horse Racing. Pakenham Cup Day, Ingham Charity Racecaday and Gateway Racecaday. **5.00** Seven News At 5. **5.30** Border Security: Australia's Front Line. **6.00** Seven News. **7.00** Cricket. Women's Big Bash League. Final. **10.30** Women's Big Bash League Final Post-Game. Coverage of the WBBL Final post-game. **11.00** **MOVIE:** The Rock. (1996) Sean Connery. **2.00** Home Shopping. **4.00** It's Academic. **5.00** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **10.00** Today Extra Summer. **12.00** Our State On A Plate. **12.30** Find My Beach House Australia. **1.00** Drive Safer. **1.30** My Way. **2.00** Ready Vet Go: The Vet Paramedics. **2.30** Eatwell Christmas With Emma Dean. **3.30** Getaway Presents France. **4.30** The Garden Gurus. **5.00** 9News First At Five. **5.30** Find My Country House Australia. **6.00** 9News Saturday. **7.00** A Current Affair. **7.30** **MOVIE:** Avatar. (2009) Sam Worthington. **10.45** **MOVIE:** The Domestics. (2018) **12.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **8.00** I Fish. **8.30** On The Fly. **9.00** 4x4 Adventures. **10.00** My Market Kitchen. **10.30** GCBC. **11.00** Airport 24/7. **12.00** Everyday Gourmet. **12.30** Farm To Fork. **1.00** Silvia's Italian Masterclass. Final. **1.30** The Yes Experiment. **2.00** 4x4 Adventures. **3.00** Dogs Behaving (Very) Badly Australia. **4.00** All 4 Adventure. **5.00** 10 News. **6.30** The Dog House UK. **7.30** Selling Houses Australia. **8.40** Location, Location, Location Australia. **9.40** FBI: Most Wanted. **11.30** Late Programs.



6.00 Morning Programs. **12.00** WorldWatch. **2.00** When The World Watched. **3.25** Cycling. Cape To Cape MTB. H'lights. **4.45** Who Do You Think You Are? **5.35** Britain Under The Nazis. New. **6.30** SBS World News. **7.30** Wham! Last Christmas Unwrapped. **8.40** Alpine Hotel At Christmas. **9.35** Osborne House: A Royal Retreat. **10.50** The Real Spies Among Friends. **11.45** Homicide: Life On The Street. **3.05** Being Beethoven. **4.10** Growing A Greener World. **4.40** Bamay. **5.00** Late Programs.

7two **6.00** Morning Programs. **1.00** Harry's Practice. **1.30** Medical Emergency. **2.00** Christmas With The Salvos. **2.30** Better Homes And Gardens. **5.00** Horse Racing. Pakenham Cup Day, Ingham Charity Racecaday and Gateway Racecaday. **6.00** Dog Patrol. **6.30** Bondi Vet. **7.30** The Yorkshire Vet. **8.30** Escape To The Country. **11.30** Late Programs.

7mate **6.00** Morning Programs. **1.00** Blokesworld. **1.30** Cool Cars & Bikes. **2.00** Rides Down Under: Workshop Wars. **3.00** Motor Racing. Sunraysia Safari. **4.00** Desert Collectors. **5.00** Counting Cars. **6.00** Pawn Stars. **7.00** Storage Wars. **7.30** **MOVIE:** Grown Ups 2. (2013) **9.30** **MOVIE:** The Kingdom. (2007) Jamie Foxx. **11.50** Late Programs.

7flix **6.00** Morning Programs. **12.00** Yummy Mummies. **1.00** Starstruck. **2.30** Extended Family. **3.00** Dancing With The Stars: All Stars. **4.30** Monkeys Make You Laugh Out Loud. **5.25** **MOVIE:** A Dog's Purpose. (2017) **7.30** **MOVIE:** Mrs. Harris Goes To Paris. (2022) Lesley Manville. **10.00** **MOVIE:** Erin Brockovich. (2000) **12.45** Late Programs.

10 drama **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.00** JAG. **3.00** Camper Deals. **3.30** Tough Tested. **4.30** Soccer. A-League Men. Round 8. Western Sydney Wanderers v Brisbane Roar. **7.00** Football Tonight. **7.35** Soccer. A-League Men. Round 8. Melbourne Victory v Adelaide United. **10.00** NCIS. **11.55** Late Programs.

10 comedy **6.00** The Bold And The Beautiful. **8.30** Ghosts. **10.00** Ridiculousness. **11.00** Farm To Fork. **11.30** Deal Or No Deal. **12.00** The Late Show With Stephen Colbert. **2.00** Ridiculousness. **3.00** Frasier. **4.00** Friends. **6.30** The Big Bang Theory. **10.00** Frasier. **10.30** South Park. **11.00** Ridiculousness. **12.30** South Park. **1.00** Late Programs.

Entertains **6.00** Morning Programs. **2.40** Heartbreak High. **3.25** You Can't Ask That. **3.45** Portrait Artist Of The Year. **4.40** MythBusters. **5.30** Car S.O.S. **6.15** Phil Spencer: Secret Agent. **7.05** Spicks And Specks. **7.35** QI. **8.05** Live At The Apollo. **9.35** Absolutely Fabulous. **11.05** ER. **11.50** Late Programs.

Family **6.00** Kids' Programs. **5.10** Super Monsters. **6.10** PJ Masks. **6.30** The Adventures Of Paddington. **6.50** Andy And The Band. **7.05** Phipenguins. **7.30** **MOVIE:** The Night Before Christmas In Wonderland. (2024) **8.50** Chopped Junior. **9.30** Fresh Off The Boat. **10.15** Abbott Elementary. **10.35** Late Programs.

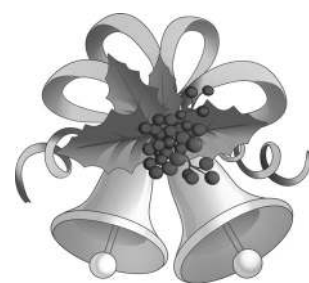
NEWS **6.00** Morning Programs. **3.00** News. **3.30** If You're Listening. **3.55** News. **4.25** Boyer Lecture Series. **5.00** News. **5.30** The Best Of Asia News Week. **6.00** Evening News. **6.30** Culture By Design. **7.00** National News. **7.30** Compass. **8.00** News Tonight. **8.30** Deep Time. **9.00** Nightly News. **9.30** The Pacific. **10.00** Late Programs.

Gem **6.00** Morning Programs. **12.45** **MOVIE:** The Man Who Loved Redheads. (1955) **2.40** **MOVIE:** How To Stuff A Wild Bikini. (1965) **4.40** **MOVIE:** Chitty Chitty Bang Bang. (1968) **7.30** Death In Paradise. **8.30** **MOVIE:** Live And Let Die. (1973) Roger Moore, Yaphet Kotto. **11.00** **MOVIE:** The Thomas Crown Affair. (1968) **1.05** Late Programs.

VICELAND **6.00** Morning Programs. **3.35** WorldWatch. **4.35** PBS NewsHour. **5.35** Mastermind Australia. **6.35** Inside Legoland: A World Of Wonder. **7.35** Impossible Engineering. **8.30** The Count Of Monte Cristo. New. **10.40** Snowpiercer. **12.25** Letterkenny. **1.55** NHK World English News.



Wellington & District **LEADER**



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**Support Local,
Celebrate the Season
and you could win \$100
each week to spend at one of
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Fill-in a coupon when you purchase an item from any of our participating businesses and you could be one of the lucky winners of \$100 spending spree at the business of your choice.

Each draw will take place at one of our participating businesses each week.

There is one (1) draw to go to be drawn at The Lemon Tree this Saturday morning.



Wellington

Craft

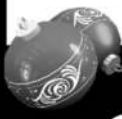
WEEKDAYS | 10AM - 4PM WEEKENDS | 10AM - 2PM WEEKENDS | 146 PERCY STREET | 7 DAYS A WEEK

Christmas Gifts for Everyone

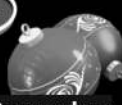
Individually hand crafted



Ben, Bek and staff would like to Thank you for your support this year and wish you...



A VERY MERRY CHRISTMAS and Happy New Year!



Close Wed, 24 December Reopen 29 December

Closed January 1 & 2

For Emergency Service call 0401 950 922

Locally owned and operated

People return for Jespresso's unique coffee flavour, time and time again



NOTED FOR being there when one's in need of a coffee, the team at Jespresso are open from 7am every morning except Sunday.

They're allowed one day off a week, surely.

Owner Jess Gough has just clocked-up 10 years of coffee and cafe service in Wellington and her plans have no time for her to slow down.

Her Jespresso coffee is unique. It's a blend she made herself from multiple tastings (cuppings) - a blend she named Lily's blend after her Sharpai.

She says her blend has caramel overtones and chocolate richness

enveloped in full resonating body extracted from Papua New Guinea, Ethiopia, India and Columbia beans.

The coffee Jess makes is steeped in decades of honing her barista skills.

And of course tea of many varieties, smoothies or a good ol' fashion milk shake.

They're all available just for the asking.

Natural fruit and or vegetable juices are also a specialty, with fruit taken out of the cold display cabinet, juiced in front of your eyes.

Toasties, burgers, chips, wraps, sandwiches filled with anything your tastebuds desire.

Convenience of knowing

Jespresso is open from early morning to 2pm has been the business' major appeal to customers, many of whom are more than regulars. You can set your clock on some.

Jespresso will be closed on Christmas Day, but opens again from 8am to 1pm on Boxing Day then back to 7am opening except January 1 when the cafe opens at 8am.

Best keep an eye out when you visit to make sure you note the trading hours during the Christmas and New Year break.

In the meantime, Jess and the girls wish all a Merry Christmas and a Happy New Year.



Make this a Magical Christmas Unwrap Unbeatable Bargains by Shopping Locally



Babies and tyres will make 2026 a memorable year at Ben's Tyres



IS IT Wellington water? Or just coincidental timing.

The team at Ben's Tyres are not only celebrating the business's 10th anniversary this month at the Gobolion/Lee Street site, but the partners of all three of the tyre servicemen are expecting babies from as early as February.

Ben's partner, Bek is due in 11 weeks while Craig Madden's partner Amy Cummings and Luke Ryan's partner Stephany McCarthy are due further towards mid-year.

Ben Blackhall said he began his new tyre business in mid-December 10 years ago and his first client was Neil Eckart of Schute Sales Australia.

He said he started changing tyres under his own name with one other assistant and in the decade, has built the business strong enough to

employ four people.

And that's thanks for local support and trust in his work ethics.

An important part of the business is vulcanising ag tyres.

Major cuts can be fixed in no time enabling cost savings at times like sowing or harvest when money is invested in paddocks.

But just as important, the family vehicle or car needs some TLC this time of year, especially if the family is planning a trip away for holidays.

This is the time to make sure the vehicle is in tip-top order - just drop it in for the team to check tyres and spare, and battery.

The team provides quick and reliable on-the-spot service at any time of day.

But keep in mind the holiday period is now upon us and the tyre

service shop will be closed from Christmas Eve (Wednesday, December 24) and reopens on December 29, then closes for January 1st and 2nd.

Then it's back to normal providing a wide range of tyre types and brands for cars, four-wheel drives, ag vehicles and machinery, or motor bikes and golf buggies.

There's every type in stock, and if not, can be delivered overnight.

It's service with a smile at Ben's Tyres - call in and check for yourself.

However, there is an emergency call-out service if tyres need replacing during this period.

Ben is just a phonecall away on 0427 162 066.

The team says 'many thanks' to the wonderful supporters of their local Wellington business.

Geurie's village charm and the outdoor space attracts

A LONGLASTING friendship established when working together at Dubbs's Old Bank restaurant is now a thriving partnership at The Lemon Tree Café on the Mitchell Highway at Geurie.

Owners, Tina and Andrea fell in love with Geurie soon after Tina moved to the village, but the availability of the café with space to expand was the drawcard of the two establishing The Lemon Tree café.

The café, nestled in this wonderful village on the highway between Wellington and Dubbo has become a definite meeting place for locals from both towns as well as from the Geurie locality..

Travellers have discovered the café as well, and from comments

by customers, they say they called in because friends said it was a friendly and clean café serving good food and drinks.

The café entices families and friends to stop and catch up over a morning coffee or tea or cool drink together with a snack or a more fulfilling meal, maybe for brunch.

The girls only opened the café a month or two back, but from their early success they have some plans in place for 2026 that will include sipping Sundays with a musician and other entertainment.

Seven Mile Coffee roasters blend Bills beans Mr Smooth is the blend the café is noted for and their best seller from the menu is their Legends Breakfast roll which has my Andrea's family

recipe tomato relish.

Brunch on weekends are a definite for many visitors who have predetermined a drive, either from Wellington or Dubbo or surrounds just to arrive at that mid to late morning time-frame.

The girls say their house sodas and smoothies are a hit during this warm weather.

Normal opening hours are Thursday and Friday from 6am to 2pm while Saturday and Sunday the café is open from 8am to 2pm.

And located next door to Jacinta Haycocks art gallery, the two businesses find customers are staying longer and making an outing of their visit and taking away fond memories.

And many keep returning.

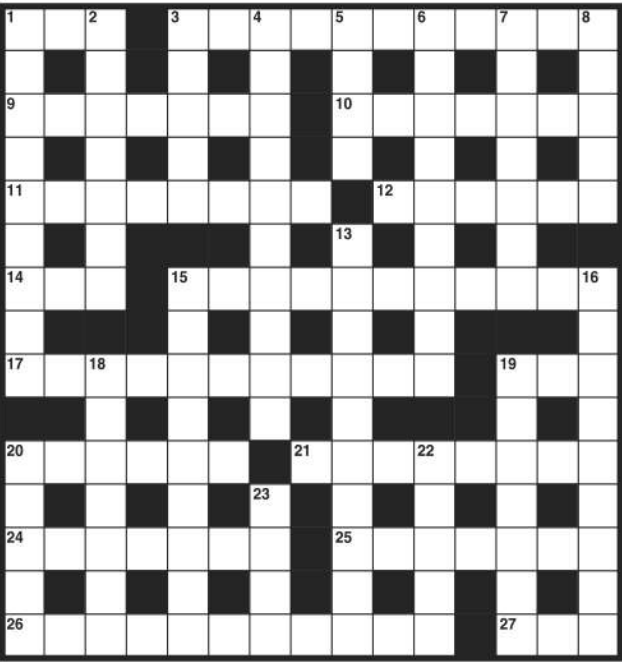


Wellington and Geurie businesses supporting the "Leader's" Magical Christmas Shopping Spree

- * Ben's Tyres
- * Caves Wood Gallery & Gifts
- * Cusack's Butchery
- * Four Cats Coffee
- * Jacinta Haycock Gallery
- * Jespresso Cafe
- * Mallee Hen's Nest & Cafe

- * NJ Jewellers
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- * One Stop Auto
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- * The Lemon Tree Cafe
- * Wellington Craft Co-op

CROSSWORD



- ACROSS**

1 Trophy (3)

3 Great playwright (11)

9 Finger-end guard (7)

10 Chat (7)

11 Follower of Martin Luther (8)
- 12 2000 Olympic city (6)

14 And not (3)

15 Free (11)

17 Body of water to the East of Italy (8,3)

19 South (Span.) (3)

20 Royal male (6)

- 21 Original (8)

24 Drank (7)

25 Porch (7)

26 Anarchy (11)

27 Gosh (3)
- DOWN**
- 1 Disputed Spanish region (9)
- 2 Hint (7)
- 3 Cavalry sword (5)
- 4 Mediterranean port of Egypt (10)
- 5 Catch sight of (4)
- 6 Excessively optimistic person (9)
- 7 Progress (7)
- 8 Before time (5)
- 13 Punctuation mark (10)
- 15 Showing a tendency to be easily angered (9)
- 16 Group of three taking part in an activity (9)
- 18 Colourful arc (7)
- 19 Voyaging on water (7)
- 20 Small bottle (arch.) (5)
- 22 Classifies (5)
- 23 Combines (4)

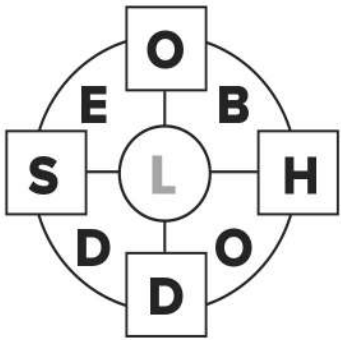


9-LETTER

No. 153

Using the nine letters in the grid, how many words of four letters or more can you list? The centre letter must be included and each letter may only be used once. No colloquial or foreign words. No capitalised nouns, apostrophes or plural words ending in "s".

- Today's Aim:**
- 19 words: **Good**
- 28 words: **Very good**
- 38 words: **Excellent**

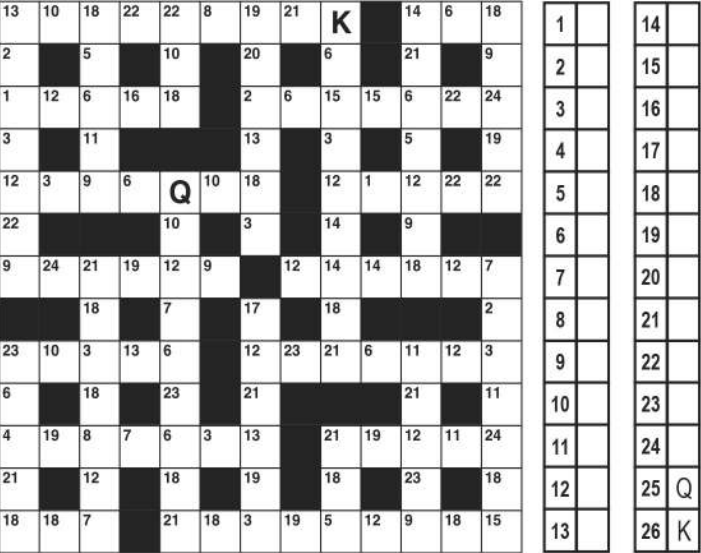


behold, beholds, bled,
blood, blooded, bloods,
bole, bolo, boodle,
dole, doled, doles,
doodle, doodles, held,
hold, holds, hole, holed,
holes, 'lobe, lobed, lobo,
lobs, lode, loos, loose,
loosed, lose, 'leo, slop,
slope, sold, sole, solo,

CODEWORD

No. 103

Each number corresponds to a letter of the alphabet. Two have been filled in for you, can you work out the rest?



SOLUTIONS: 1=M, 2=Y, 3=N, 4=B, 5=Y, 6=L, 7=L, 8=W, 9=T, 10=U, 11=C, 12=A, 13=G, 14=P, 15=D, 16=Z, 17=J, 18=E, 19=O, 20=X, 21=R, 22=S, 23=F, 24=H

QUICK QUIZ

- 1 Which artist designed the costumes and sets for Igor Stravinsky's ballet *Pulcinella*?

2 To be certified as Rainforest Alliance coffee, what percentage of the coffee must be produced under the Rainforest Alliance criteria?

3 Who wrote the novel *The Secret Garden*?

4 Mickey Rooney and Frank Sinatra both married which actress?

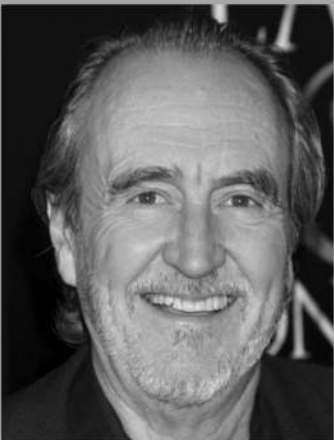
5 Colcannon is a traditional dish of which country?
- 6 'Goedenavond' means good evening in what language?

7 Found in the ocean, the Portuguese man-o-war is also known as what species in Australia?

8 Wes Craven (pictured) directed which 1999 musical drama?

9 Quoyle, a newspaper reporter on the island of Newfoundland, is the protagonist of which Pulitzer Prize-winning novel?

10 Which actor played the Penguin in *Batman Returns*?



ANSWERS: 1. Pablo Picasso 2. 90 per cent 3. *The Shipping News* 4. Danny DeVito 5. Ireland 6. Dutch 7. Blue bottle jellyfish 8. *Music of the Heart* 9. The Penguin 10. Michael Keaton

No. 153

WORDFIT

No. 063

- 3 LETTERS**

AGE

ARE

AVO

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GEE

GEL

GOO

HAY

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PEA

PRY

RAM

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TAR
- 5 LETTERS**

ACHED

ACUTE

ADAPT

ADORE

ADORN

AGENT

ANGEL

APRIL

ARISE

BURRO

CELLO

CRASS

DEEMS

DOERS

ENTER

EQUAL

ERROR

ESSAY

HEELS

IRKED

LEGAL

LINES

LOUSY

NOOSE

NOSED

ONION

OUNCE

PALER

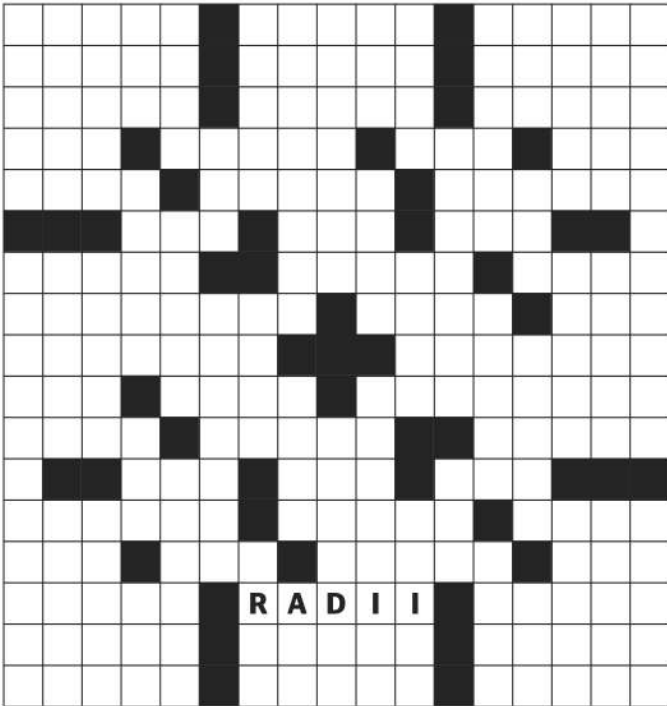
PATIO

RADII

RAPID

SCALE

SEEDS



- 6 LETTERS**

COLOUR

LATTER

NUCLEI

RELAYS
- 8 LETTERS**

EQUIPPED

FESTOONS

FLOORING

SEESAWED
- 11 LETTERS**

ASSIMILATED

SELFISHNESS
- 7 LETTERS**

AVOIDED

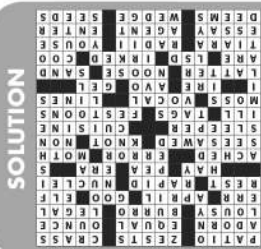
CUISINE

ONEROUS

SLEEPER

SURLIER

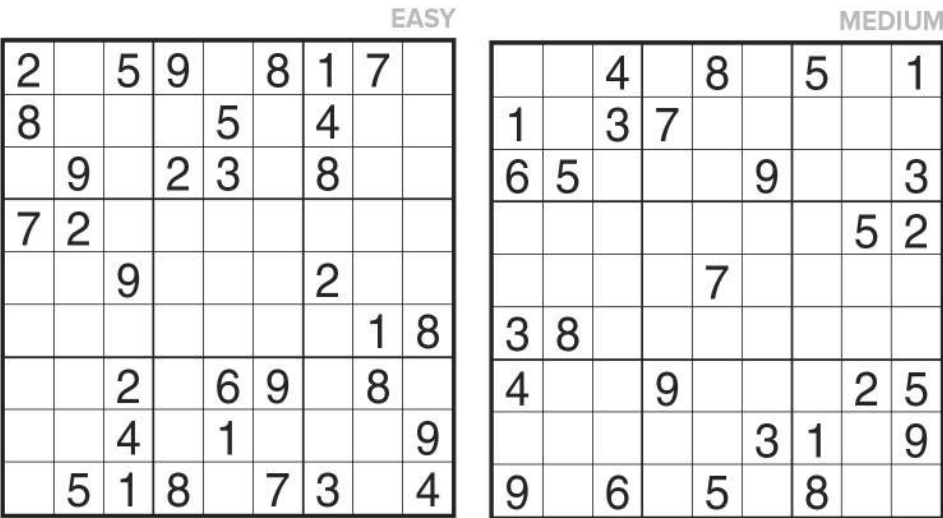
WEAVERS



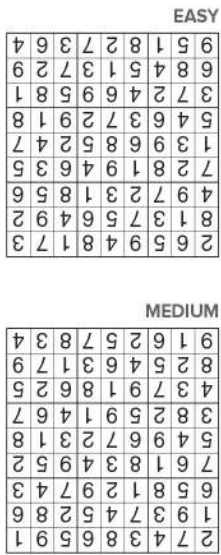
SUDOKU

No. 153

To solve a Sudoku puzzle, every number from 1 to 9 must appear in: each of the nine vertical columns, each of the nine horizontal rows and each of the nine 3 x 3 boxes. Remember, no number can occur more than once in any row, column or box.



SOLUTIONS



WORD SEARCH

No. 063

Can you find all the words listed? The leftover letters will spell out a secret message.



- PRINCETON
- QUEENSLAND
- RICE
- ST ANDREWS
- STANFORD
- SYDNEY
- UCL
- UNSW
- UWA
- WARWICK
- WASHINGTON
- YALE
- YONSEI
- ZHEJIANG
- ZURICH

SECRET MESSAGE: the brightest minds will change the world

'ONE STOP SHOP' DIRECTORY

MACQUARIE
PLUMBING & GAS



Jacob Perry
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AGRI TOPICS

Information for the Man on the Land

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Another dry week although we had light showers on a couple of days, but not enough to measure. Friday and Saturday were scorches – and the winds! The good news is Christmas Eve and Christmas Day will be dry and pleasant 32 degrees, however Boxing Day will be 32 degrees with a thunder shower of around 4mm.

***WEEVILKINEVIL:** A biocontrol hope for fleabane. A tiny South American insect could be the next big thing in weed control for Australian grain growers.

CSIRO researchers, supported by GRDC, are investigating the stem-boring weevil “lixus caudiger” nick-named Weevil Kinevil - as a biological control agent for flaxleaf fleabane, one of the most costly and invasive weeds in cropping systems.

The weevil feed on its leaves and stems, while its larvae burrow into the plant’s core, weakening it and preventing seed production. Early trials show the insect is highly specialised to fleabane and poses no threat to crops or native flora.

Pending regulatory approval “Weevil Knievel” may one day become a key ally in the fight against Fleabane.

Note: I have seen the spread of fleabane in this district and it needs urgent attention before it becomes more invasive.

Markets at a glance

WOOL Merino skirtings were the star sector last week. The EMI closed 1523c/kg clean, up 17c. 35,335 bales (including 2143 NZ bales) down 3826 bales. Sydney Merino flc - a small selection of stylish superfine lots unchanged on day 1 and lifted on day 2. Merino skirtings - broken lines continue in the spotlight. Prices for all types and descriptions strengthened. Crossbred prices firm on back of limited selection. Oddments, a small selection unchanged on as fine locks and lots with combing length lifted. Cardings up 2c. NRI 1560c/kg clean, up 19c. Sydney pass-in 3.7% with 288 bales withdrawn.

CATTLE. CTLX Carcoar, 2nd, 3551 down 141. Young trade cattle lifted

15c, yearling steers 350c to 484c, heifers 350c to 454c/kg. Feeder steers gained 10c on medium weights, 450c to 527c/kg, heifers 15c dearer, 410c to 460c/kg. Grown steers 5c better, 360c to 476c, heifers eased 2c, 350c to 459c/kg. Cows firm, 2 and 3 scores 290c to 409c. Heavy cows 398c to 425c/kg. Heavy bulls to 440c/kg

SHEEP CTLX. 4145 sheep (-616), 5058 lambs (-2232). Light new season lambs to process dearer, \$190 to \$230. Trade new season lambs 20kg to 24kg dropped \$15 to \$20, \$234 to \$278, ave 1080c to 1120c/kg cwt. Heavy over 28kg down \$25, \$275 to \$336. Young lambs to restockers \$10 cheaper, \$80 to \$225. Old trade lambs \$200 to \$274. Heavies \$286 to \$300. Heavy hoggets to \$249. Mutton. Prices lifted \$5. Merino ewes \$70 to \$210, crossbreds to \$279. Crossbred weathers \$225. Rams to \$150.

PIGS:- FORBES 28th. Smaller yarding of sows saw prices improve 10 to 20c/kg on last sale. Boars firm. Bacon prices improve \$20 to \$30 due to small offering. Pork prices improved \$60 to \$70 in small offering. A much larger yarding of suckers mainly on the lighter side, prices slip \$20 to \$40.. Bacon \$280 to \$318. Light pork \$248 to \$362, suckers \$140 to \$200, Sows c/kg \$80 to \$134. Boars c/kg lwt \$10 to \$20.

STOCK CLEARANCE Continues



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WEEKLY MARKET REPORT

Week ending December 5, 2025

AWEX Northern Micron Indices Comparison

AWEX INDEX	This Week \$23/25	This Week M23/25	Last Sale \$22/25	Sydney Change	Last Year Sydney	Sydney Yearly Change
17	2133	2096	2118	+15	1702	+431
18	2013	2013	2000	+11	1522	+491
19	1909	1909	1869	+24	1413	+496
20	1826n	1826	1812n	+14	1352	+474
21	-	1819	-	-	1322n	-
26	755n	762	-	-23	564	+191
28	645n	666	660n	-15	397n	+248
MC	807n	759n	805n	+2	706	+101

Onwards and upwards!

MARKET gained positive territory last week with gains across the board pushing the EMI higher by 17 cents to 1521 and most notably back over the US\$ mark of 1000 cents for the first time since the big rally in late September. Also, of note was the broader Merino indices which are now higher than the level set in that rally. Most fleece indices moved upwards between 10 and 40 cents but the skirtings, particularly good length, low VM types sold much better. No doubt at this time of year we see a better style wool offered which always helps, but the fundamentals driving the market are changing from supply driven to demand driven which bode well for the post-Christmas sales. The year-to-date AWTA testing figures came out early and the volume decline is still above 10%, yet the amount of wool offered year to date is down 5%. This indicates that the difference of around 33,000 bales has come from grower held stocks. Just how much wool there is in grower held stocks is pure speculation but whilst this

number dwindles and fresh supply does the same it’s not hard to predict a stronger market in the New Year. It’s interesting to look back at where we were in 2018 and hypothesise at where previous resistance points were. The EMI peaked a couple of times at just over 2100 cents and just over 1500 USD cents. The 17-micron price levels reached over 600 cents above today’s levels whilst 19 and 20 microns were 550 cents and 480 cents respectively above today. So, whilst it’s great news that we have a decent recovery in place, there’s quite a way to go to reach relatively recent highs. The prices in 2018 were widely agreed at the time to be unsustainable and one could say the global economic conditions were in better shape than now. There is one haunting similarity between now and mid-2018 and that’s rainfall or lack thereof!

This week Macwool and Carmichael wool offered 820 bales yesterday with a national offering estimated at 41,000 bales and some confidence that the market could hold its ground.

YOUR WOOL IN SAFE HANDS



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Stock report by Ross Plasto

DUBBO CATTLE. 10,700. Good numbers in all sections and fair numbers of young cattle to suit feeders and backgrounders. Most buyers operating in another solid market. Young trade cattle a little dearer, steer vealers and yearlings 425c to 490c/kg. Heavy feeder steers 8c dearer, lighter steers and heifers firm to 8c/kg cheaper. Feeder steers 390c to 517c, feeder heifers 370c to 460c/kg. Young cattle to restockers up to 15c cheaper, young steers to 554c, heifers to 486c/kg. Grown steers 3c to 8c dearer, heifers 15c/kg cheaper. Grown steers 442c to 485c, heifers 400c to 450c/kg. Secondary cows 10c to 12c cheaper, well finished heavy weights firm. Two and 3 score cows to processors 300c to 402c/kg. Heavy cows 379c to 430c, ave 407c/kg. Heavy bulls to 412c/kg.

DUBBO LAMB. 22,000. Merino and Dorper lambs well supplied as well as large numbers of hoggets. Firm to dearer market. Light processing lambs to 18kg \$88 to \$200. Trade 20kg to 24kg \$220 to \$287, ave 1100c/kg cwt. Heavy lambs over 24kg \$286 to \$370. Trade Merino lambs to \$275, light crossbred lambs to restockers to \$200. Heavy hoggets to \$280.

DUBBO MUTTON. 18,000, prices were strong. Merino ewes \$85 to \$310, crossbred ewes \$134 to \$270. Merino wethers to \$166, heavy Dorper wethers to \$224. Most sheep 720c to 800c/kg cwt.

DUBBO STORE Cattle. Last store sale for year. 1115 head. Some top runs of weaners, fair numbers starting to show effects of dry season. Tough steer weaner market. Best weaner steers Herefords from Corrodgery to \$1650. Balance of steer weaners \$400 for light Bos Indicus crosses to \$1610 for Angus. Other breeds and cross-

Around the tracks with Col Hodges

Racing at Mudgee

JACOB STIFF had his first race ride in late winter 2025 and three months and 10 wins later he has won a feature event, the \$75,000 Robert Oatley-Big Dance Eligibility-Mudgee Cup (1400 metres).on Dances With Hooves.

The 18-year-old Jacob Stiff hails from the village of Ballimore, outside Dubbo, and since beginning his apprenticeship with Dubbo trainer Michael Mulholland has displayed immense ability in the saddle.

His ride at Mudgee on Friday aboard the Cameron Crockett, Scone trained Dances With Hooves was outstanding from the outset when he found a reasonable position after jumping from an outside barrier in the 13-horse field.

New Business led from Jacenza, Walking Painting and Aimpoint in the run to the home turn while Dances With Hooves was beginning a move from the back half of the field.

Swooping on the outside, Dances With Hooves (\$12) won by a length from Rematch (Aaron Bullock, \$3.80) with the \$2.60 favourite Istoleamer (Winona Costin) getting third in a photo from Super Helpful.

Cameron Crockett had earlier supplied the quinnella in the 1400m Yves Premium Cuvée Class 1 Showcase Handicap when Ghaznavi (Jenny Duggan, \$8.50) came from last to beat Jagerschnitzel (Aaron Bullock, \$3) by a nose with Amanoah (Jean Van Overmeire, \$6) a handy third.

Mudgee based trainer Cheryl Crockett, the mother of Cameron Crockett, completed a big day for the family when her eight-year-old grey mare The Artefact (Winona Costin, \$10 to \$7) after racing near the front beat the leader Barcoo River (Jake Pracey-Holmes, \$17) and Halo Phenomena (Aaron Bullock, \$3.50 equal fav) in the 1200m Wild Oats Wines Country Magic BM 58 Handicap.

The father and daughter trainer partners Brett Cavanough and Georgie Cavanough from Scone landed a winning double with Master Speed and Saratoga Power. In the 1200m Four In Hand Barossa Shiraz Maiden Plate, Master Speed (Kody Nestor, \$11) finished quickly from last to account for Bellerata (Mikayla Weir, \$6) and Marebello (Grant Buckley, \$3.70) while Kody Nestor was also aboard Saratoga Power (\$3.80 to \$7) a strong fishing winner over The Dramatist (Leeshelle Small, \$14) and Stratified (Jake Pracey-Holmes, \$6) in the 1200m Cup Day Sprint.

The other winners were both ridden by Grant Buckley, the Tracey Bartley, Wyong trained Banyan Tree (\$2.80 fav) and Butterfly Style (\$4.80) trained at Kembla Grange by Mitchell Beer & George Carpenter.

Racing at Warren tomorrow (Friday), Coonamble Saturday and Orange on Monday.

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SPROUTS GRADUATION



Sprouts Graduation Day! We are so proud of our little 'Sprouts' as they officially graduate from the School Readiness Program today! They are now ready to hit the ground running for Kindergarten next year. Congratulations to the Class of 2025! We can't wait to see you shine.

YEAR 1/2



Our Year 1/2 students learned the basics of golf this week—practising gentle aiming and controlled putting—thanks to Mr Green's expert guidance. They also witnessed another milestone in Science as their mealworm has transformed!

YEAR 3-6



It has been a busy week for our Year 3-6 students. Year 3 Girls Group celebrated Christmas with treats, crafts, worship, and fellowship focusing on Jesus. Year 5 and 6 started the week participating in the Seniors Christmas Morning Tea at the Wellington Civic Centre, and in sport, they learned basic golf skills, focusing on aim and technique.



A Vector Images art.

Drake Inquiry report to reform greyhound industry governance

A RANGE of measures and actions aimed at strengthening the governance, integrity and animal welfare standards of greyhound racing industry in NSW has been released by the state government.

These measures respond to the findings of the inquiry led by the Hon. Lea Drake, appointed by Minister for Gaming and Racing David Harris, to address concerns regarding Greyhound Racing NSW (GRNSW).

Acting Commissioner Drake identified significant governance and operational failures within Greyhound Racing NSW under previous management, including deficiencies in procurement and recruitment practices, financial mismanagement, wasteful expenditure and a poor workplace culture.

In response to this report, the Government is taking action to ensure the industry lifts standards and practices by reform-

ing the industry’s operating licence and issuing a Statement of Expectations to the regulator.

New operating Licence for Greyhound Racing NSW The NSW Government will issue GRNSW with a new Operating Licence that sets out conditions legally requiring the organisation to address key recommendations of the Drake Inquiry to ensure its operations meet the highest standards of governance and animal welfare, including:

- * increasing oversight of greyhound rehoming programs run by GRNSW and third-party groups to significantly improve rehoming pathways, including prioritising domestic rehoming programs where possible
- * ensuring sustainable and transparent funding for animal welfare
- * improving reporting on greyhound rehoming data
- * improving reporting to the

Greyhound Welfare Integrity Commission (GWIC) on greyhound deaths from unknown causes

- * ensuring updates to the minimum track standards are actioned appropriately and implemented across all clubs
- * improving a suite of internal GRNSW’s policies, Board Charters and Code of Conduct to lift standards around organisational management, human resources, procurement process, financial and human resource management and workplace culture
- * setting requirements for reporting by GRNSW on progress with implementing these reforms.

As is required in Section 25 of the Greyhound Racing Act 2017, Minister Harris will consult with the industry’s regulator, GWIC, on the updated licence before issuing it to GRNSW.

Wentworth Park to make way for housing

THE STATE Government’s zest for more housing in Sydney is behind the closure of Greyhound racing at Sydney’s Wentworth Park 2027.

Wentworth Park, located in Glebe, has been the home of NSW greyhound racing since 1932, Wentworth Park, located in Glebe on the outskirts of Sydney’s CBD.

Plans are for the demolition of the 14-hectare track and facilities and surrounding parkland to make way for new housing and community sporting fields.

Greyhound Racing NSW (GRNSW) and NSW

Greyhound, Breeders, Owners & Trainers Association (GBOTA) officials had tabled a new vision to the Government - “Wentworth Park Renaissance” which aimed to “reinvigorate the precinct with lively public space that served as a multipurpose sporting facility”.

The Government’s decision including a \$10m funding injection into the sport’s Capital Grants Program (CGP), has been likened to the government appearing to be closing the greyhound industry by stealth, according to GRNSW chief executive Steve Griffin.

Public liability for landholders neighbouring renewable energy projects clarified

THE AUSTRALIAN Energy Infrastructure Commissioner (AEIC) Tony Mahar has released a position statement addressing concerns held by landholders relating to public liability insurance and renewable energy infrastructure.

The Commissioner recently brought together stakeholders from the renewable energy industry, the insurance sector and from farming groups to discuss a pathway forward which would clarify questions and provide certainty for communities and landholders.

All stakeholders agreed there was a lack of clarity and certainty in the insurance space, which was making a difficult task more difficult.

Mr Mahar said landholders living nearby to renewable infrastructure should not face increased insurance liability or costs. “This collaborative initiative aims to help build social licence, a genuine partnership with rural and regional communities, and improve landholder con-

fidence.” There was agreement that to deliver confidence for landholders, predictability for developers/operators, and certainty for governments and insurers, a nationally consistent framework on public liability insurance is essential. The national framework would apply to large wind and solar farms, batteries, pumped hydro, and transmission projects. The Commissioner’s view, which was supported by the insurance industry, renewables sector and farming groups is that the community expects fair and reasonable protection from liability resulting from accidental damage to infrastructure.

The adoption of a model, where developers/operators of renewable energy facilities would contractually protect neighbouring landholders for losses or liability involving project infrastructure, should be pursued.

Mr Mahar said the respective stakeholders had agreed to work collaboratively to establish and develop an insurance product or

policy that supported this national approach and communicate these products to developers/operators and landholders through established channels.

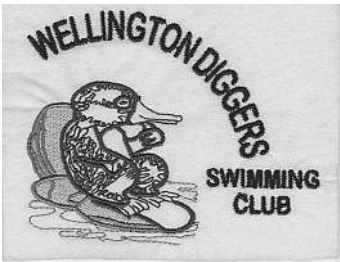
The Clean Energy Council have expressed strong support for the progression of the initiative and look forward to working with AEIC on this initiative.

William Churchill, Chief Policy and Impact Officer at Clean Energy Council said this was ultimately about being a good neighbour and community member.

“Clean energy projects succeed when the people who live alongside them feel respected and protected, and this approach is a practical demonstration of that commitment.”

The AEIC looks forward to continuing to engage with developers, insurers, farming groups, and regulators to develop a simple, nationally consistent approach, with the AEIC playing an oversight role to ensure fairness and transparency.

Wellington Diggers Swimming Club



ELEVEN MEMBERS participated in our weekly swim on Tuesday, December 2.

Terry Dray won the 30-metre event being 0.06 outside his time. Luke Wykes having his first swim of the season won the 50-metre event being 0.41 outside his time.

Once again Rhylee Hill won the junior events. Ivy Lousick had her first swim in the 30-metre event.

Darcy Lousick and Katharine O’Rourke won the Brace Relay being 1.09 outside their time.

Swimming commences at 6pm each Tuesday at the Aquatic Leisure Centre.

To compete in our weekly swim adults must be members of the

Wellington Soldiers Memorial Club and for juniors to compete a family member must compete on the night.

Membership is \$2 for adults, swim cost is \$5 per person plus pool entry. After swim barbecue is included.

The Western District Championships will be held in Cobar on Sunday, February 8 2026. Cost will be advised.

New Members are always welcome for more information contact Terry Dray – 0408 294 526.

Juniors
30 Metre: 1 Rhylee Hill 0.13; 2 Darcy Lousick 0.59; 3 Tilly Hill 9.13.
50 Metre: 1 Rhylee Hill 4.62; 2 Darcy Lousick 8.31.

Seniors
30 Metre: 1 Terry Dray 0.06; 2 Joe Ryan 0.07; 3 Wayne Rich 0.29.
50 Metre: 1 Luke Wykes 0.41; 2 Terry Dray 0.44; 3 Janelle Frappell 1.54.

Brace Relay: 1 Darcy Lousick & Katharine O’Rourke 1.09; 2 Rhylee Hill & Nick Knowles 7.25.

The Platypus



Diggers club members wait for racing events to begin on a Tuesday night at the pool. Jo Ivey Photo.

Natural Disaster declarations include Dubbo LGA

FEDERAL AND State Governments have activated disaster assistance to communities in 6 Local Government Areas (LGAs) including Dubbo LGA following a number of bushfires last week.

The declarations activate a suite of support measures for residents, businesses, primary producers, and councils. People whose homes have been damaged may be eligible for immediate financial help as well as clean-up, rebuilding and recovery assistance.

Support has been made available

under the joint Commonwealth-state Disaster Recovery Funding Arrangements (DRFA).

Community members affected by the recent bushfires should contact Service NSW on 13 77 88 or visit service.nsw.gov.au to access information on disaster assistance, grants, and recovery support.

The state government asks the community not to send physical donations. The best way to support those affected is by donating through GIVIT, the official disaster relief partner at <https://www.givit.org.au/>



GRACIE PULLBROOK has been selected into the Western PSSA girls cricket team. She will be representing at the State NSW Carnival in February next year for four days in Armidale.

Christmas Party & Coaching Session

Carmen Gain photos

Swimming club celebrates with Christmas Party and Coaching session

WELLINGTON'S LOCAL Swimming Club celebrated the end of a fantastic season with a joyful Christmas Party at the pool, bringing swimmers and families together for a memorable evening.

With the sun setting over the water, it was a beautiful night filled with laughter, fun and community spirit.

A delicious barbecue dinner was shared by all, giving everyone the opportunity to sit back, relax and connect with fellow swimming families.

Santa made a special appearance to delight the younger swimmers, before everyone jumped into a series of fun floatie races that had both participants and spectators cheering.

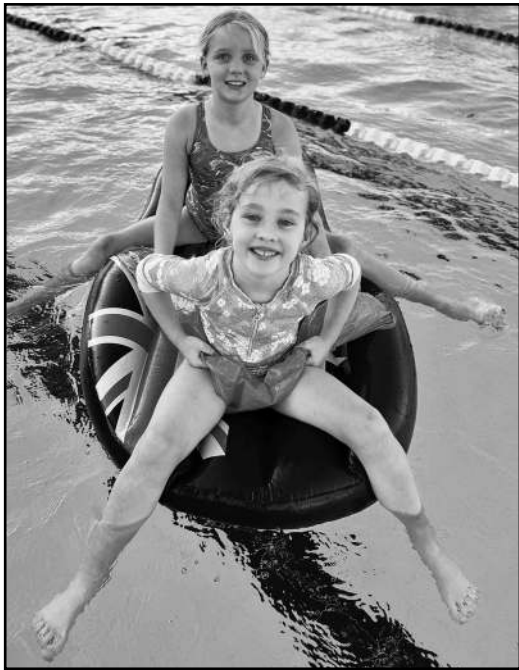
The atmosphere was relaxed and festive, allowing families the chance to unwind and enjoy time together.

This week, swimmers were also fortunate to take part in a training session with Chris Myers from Swimming NSW.

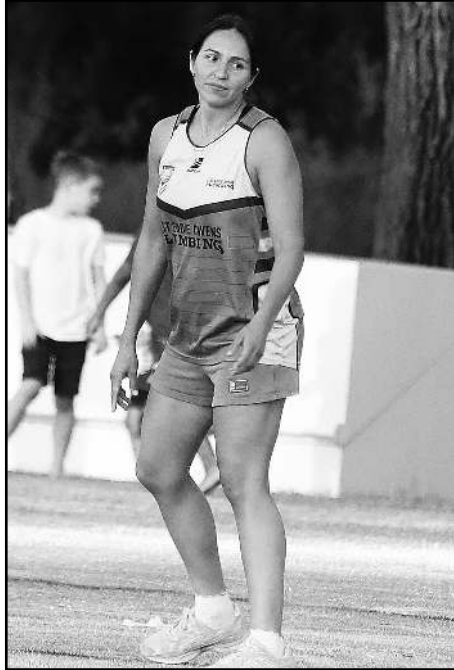
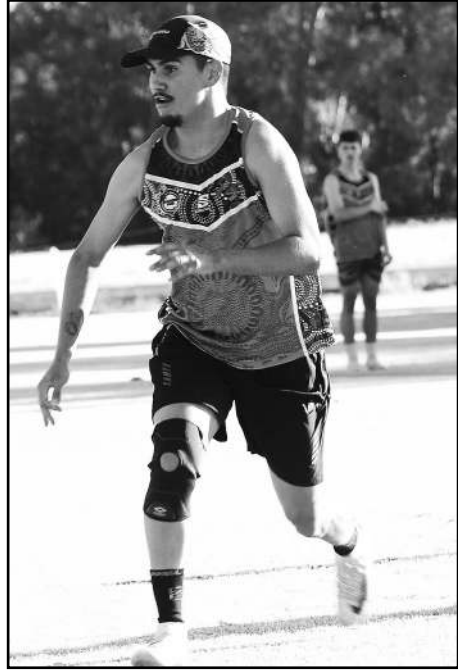
Chris generously shared his knowledge and experience with the swimmers, focusing on improving diving techniques and building confidence on the starting blocks.

Following on from this, swimmers aged 9 and up were invited to attend an additional training session on Saturday in Dubbo, joining swimmers from across Western NSW for a fantastic opportunity to develop their skills and connect with the wider swimming community.

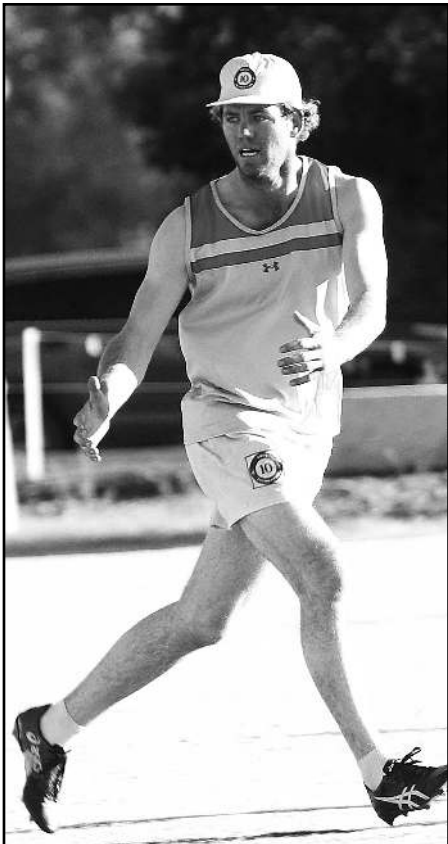
Carmen Gain



Touch Round 8 - Jo Ivey Photos



Touch Round 8 - Jo Ivey Photos



Touch competitors keener than ever

ANOTHER STRONG week of Wellington Touch competition, with Round 7 of A and B Grade and Round 8 of the junior C and D Grades played under perfect Wednesday evening conditions.

In A Grade, Biggest Mob continued their surge with a 9-4 win over TMR, while FORME edged out Bell River Hay 7-6 in one of the matches of the night.

Wolf Pack were clinical in their 4-0 victory over Wellington's Finest, and Fast Eddie Owens Plumbing held off a fast-finishing Ben's Tyres to win 6-3.

B Grade's Let It Snow post a sharp 9-4 win over Deadly Reddies, NF Electrical defeated

Morley's Earthmoving 6-3, and Lousicks snuck home 5-4 over Arthurville in a tight contest.

In C Grade, Swamp Kings impressed with a 13-3 win over Too Fast Too Fabulous, Touch Downs posted a strong 13-1 result over Pups, Wello Weapons defeated Junior Cowboys 12-4, and The Whipper Snippers were too strong for The Slippery Steppers, winning 11-2. TTG vs Warriors was declared a forfeit.

D Grade again delivered plenty of enthusiasm and improvement across all matches, with no scores kept but excellent sportsmanship on display throughout.

Abe Dearmer



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